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BETTER

BEN BOSWELL

Two Sides of Terri

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PROLOGUE

I couldn't help but laugh. I'd asked Terri to dress up for an evening out. She'd dug out a slinky black dress, but here she was, sitting on the floor, legs curled beneath her, giggling happily as she played a rousing game of Shoots and Ladders with the kids. The dress looked like a costume, and a not very convincing one. The real her was the woman there on the floor, completely focused on the kids, wholesome to a fault.

I saw the way men looked at her. That hungry look. If they only knew the truth. Not that the truth was bad. I love Terri. She's a wonderful friend, a great mother, and a caring homemaker. She's the perfect wife. But she's a good girl, albeit in a bad girl's body. I'd lived with this disconnect for so long that I didn't even think about it, not often at least.

"Honey, are you ready to go?"

She looked up at me.

"Bill, really, you didn't need to make a fuss."

"I wanted to. Come on, let's go. I promise, it'll be fun."

She jumped up lightly and gave me a kiss on the cheek. "Okay, let's do this thing."

CHAPTER 1: REVELATIONS

It was Terri's 33rd birthday, and I'd decided to throw her a "third of a century" party. We started off with a nice romantic dinner for two. Well, romantic more in theory than practice since we spent most of it talking about the kids.

Braden had just started kindergarten, and Terri had volunteered to be "classroom mom," so she was deeply involved in planning the "Turkey Feast." At some point "Thanksgiving" had stopped being politically correct or something. Anyway, there were songs to be selected, costumes to plan, a feast to be prepared.

"Some of the parents are giving me such a hard time," she lamented.

We also covered Halloween. "Annabelle wants to be a princess."

Of course, I thought to myself.

"But so does her friend Sophie, and they don't want to have the same gown, so we need to exchange ours. Do you think you could stop by the store some time this week?"

I nodded in the affirmative and drank another glass of wine.

Happily, I managed to shift Terri's attention away from the kids by the end of dinner. We got in some good people watching, and the Tiramisu was so decadent that it seemed almost inappropriate to talk about the kids while eating it.

After dinner was the highpoint of the evening, I hoped. I'd planned a trip to a downtown nightclub. I'd invited a dozen of our friends, reserved a booth, bottle service, the works. We'd dropped off the kids with my folks, so we didn't have a curfew. I was hoping it would be a blowout bash, the likes of which we hadn't enjoyed since before we first became parents six years ago—or ever really, come to think of it.

We arrived, Terri giggled apprehensively as she eyed the place. "Oh, Bill, a dance club?"

I laughed. "Yeah, let's boogie." I gave her a preview of my white man's overbite.

She laughed a little awkwardly.

I knew she felt out of her element, but figured she'd enjoy herself if I could get her to try. "Come on, it'll be fun," I encouraged.

But when we got inside, I wasn't so sure. The place was dark and loud. Real loud. The thumping bass line was palpable and jarring. And the people. It was like walking into the middle of a roman orgy. Well, not quite, but the first two women we saw were tottering on four inch heels and had dresses that barely covered their bottoms. Out on the dance floor, some of the couples were grinding on each other in ways that almost made me want to shout, *Get a room*.

I leaned in close. "It's okay, honey, people are just having fun." I patted her on the shoulder.

She gave me a queer look. "I'm not a prude, you know."

I kissed her forehead. "No, of course not," I said with as much conviction as could muster.

She gave me a slightly incredulous look before the other party guests mobbed us. Terri shrieked when she saw all of our friends. It was a great way to turn the mood around.

We drank a bunch of toasts. Then Terri lured me out onto the dance floor. Backing away from me, beckoning me toward her, she hiked up her dress to mid thigh and gave me a sexy little shimmy with a generous shot of cleavage. For a skinny girl, she has big boobs. I laughed. It was so out of character, but great to see her embracing her sexy side, swaying sensuously, her long blond hair whipping back and forth in time with the music. We danced for a while and collapsed back into the booth for more drinks and chit-chat.

The basic theme, clichéd for a birthday party but almost required, was making fun of Terri's advancing years. Terri, as usual, looked great, which made it easier to tease her. And she was also drawing a lot of attention, especially that night in a clingy party dress and spiky heels and, especially, since she was still apparently trying to convince me she wasn't a prude by grinding against me on the dance floor.

One of the guests was Janet, an old college friend of Terri's. We don't see her very much anymore. She's still single and resentful about it. She's cute enough. A ginger with big boobs, a pretty face, but a little thick in the body. At the club, Janet was pounding cranberry and vodkas like it was going out of style, which, of course, it was. And the drunker she got, the pissier she got.

At one point, she was chatting with Terri when this hot guy sidled over to them. After the first couple of dances, I'd been giving Terri space, letting her enjoy hanging out with her friends. We did everything as a couple as a rule. But tonight I'd made a conscious effort to make the evening about Terri and not "us."

So, I'd hung back, encouraged her to dance with her girlfriends, and enjoyed the attention they'd attracted out on the dance floor. Part of that was observing the various men watching from the sidelines. It was always a little bit of a thrill seeing a man checking out my wife. This guy was blond with curly hair and broad shoulders. I'd seen him observing our table all evening.

Janet had been eye-fucking him for a while, and when he approached, she turned toward him, thrusting out her boobs, her fingers twirling a strand of red hair. But the guy greeted both girls, then immediately positioned himself facing Terri, giving her his full attention. The combination of her looks and her sexy moves out on the dance floor had apparently captured his attention. Janet's face flushed hotly. She sneered sideways at Terri. Her mood didn't improve when Terri politely declined his attention and he walked away instead of chatting up Janet.

Later when the DJ went on a break, we all gathered in the booth to talk and reload our drinks. Janet was still fuming, though; sitting silently even when folks started sharing old stories about Terri. But everyone was laughing and having a good time and I stopped paying attention to Janet and her moods.

Don told the one about the Thanksgiving eve that Terri had spent driving around in the snow handing out charity turkeys. The highpoint being when an elderly African-American woman alternated between thanking her and calling her a "crazy white lady" for being out in the storm.

Ellen was more risqué and told a story about Terri getting out of a speeding ticket by flirting with the cop and flashing boob. Terri vigorously denied the allegation, claiming she hadn't realized she was showing that much cleavage. "I was breast-feeding. How'd I know they were hanging out?" She blushed bright red.

We all laughed. Those stories were pure Terri. Sweet, generous, and more than a little naive.

After a while, there was a lull in the conversation, and Janet suddenly leaned forward forcefully, almost demanding we pay attention to her. She

turned to Terri and forced a sugary smile.

“Hey Ter? I just realized. Wasn’t this the place where you and Chucky got thrown out for doing it in the bathroom?”

There were a few nervous chuckles. Terri never broke her poker face. “Is it? I thought this was the place where you got bombed on Jello shooters and puked down the front of your dress?”

Janet flushed a deep red. “No, that was....” She stopped when she saw Terri break into a malicious grin. “Never mind.”

Janet’s sourpuss became downright toxic, but happily she left a few minutes later when the DJ started back up. And after a few more awkward moments, the booze and the music got the rest of us back in a party mood.

It was a great time. I’d stupidly driven and was designated driver, so I was taking it slow, but everyone else was partying in a way that would leave them all hurting come morning.

My relative sobriety came at a price, however. Instead of completely losing myself in the party, I kept replaying Janet’s remark in my head. It was a malicious bit of snark, but I couldn’t help but notice that Terri hadn’t denied it. She’d just deflected.

Terri and I met when she was 24, so I knew she wasn’t a virgin. And I think I might have even heard of an old boyfriend named Chucky at some point over the years. But with me, Terri had always been, for lack of a better word, a real lady. It took me forever to get her into the sack, and our sex life, though frequent and often passionate, was generally pretty vanilla. Over the years, I could count on one hand the number of times we’d had sex other than in bed, and even then, the strangest place we’d ever done it was the shower. So the idea of my Terri, my wife, the mother of my children, getting thrown out of nightclub for having sex in the john threw me for a loop.

I didn’t say anything, of course. At least not while we were still in the club. But back in the car, on our way home, with Terri curled up in the passenger seat nursing a happy buzz, I couldn’t resist.

“So baby, what was that about? That thing Janet said about you getting thrown out of the club?”

“That was years ago. You don’t want to know.”

“Sure I do,” I insisted. “Sounds like something I should know.”

“*Should* know?” she replied, a tone of annoyance in her voice.

“Want to know? Is that better?”

She sighed. "Really?"

"Come on, Terri, spill it. I can take it. I've had some crazy times in my past."

She gave me a quick eye roll and then responded. "Oh, you know the old saying, *it wasn't as bad as it sounds?*" She paused for a second. "Well, in this case it was much, much worse."

I coughed in surprise.

"You okay, sweetie?" she asked, her tone playful.

"What? What do you mean?"

"I was a bad girl that night." She replied in a sultry voice, low, raspy, full of suggestion. "See, that wasn't just some night out. That was the night Chucky and I met...and, well, before we got kicked out, we'd been warned."

"Warned?"

"Uh huh."

"Why?"

"Well...I guess it started when I took off my panties while sitting at the bar and dropped them in his lap."

I gasped in shock. "Why'd you do that?"

"He asked me to," she replied simply. "And I always did have trouble saying no to Chucky." She paused to let that sink in. "But, of course, once I did that, he took it upon himself to examine how I was, um, groomed."

I was literally speechless. I swallowed hard.

"I was completely bare," she continued, the amusement obvious in her voice. "He liked that. He, um, liked that a lot. That's when we got our first warning."

"First?"

"Uh huh. We got chased away from the bar. So we went out on the dance floor. But we weren't so much dancing as dry humping. You know how that is, right? I mean, you've had crazy times."

Was she mocking me? I nodded wordlessly.

"Well," she continued, "one thing led to another, and we ended up trying to find a quiet corner in one of the booths. But they chased us out of there. That was reserved for people with bottle service. So we got our second warning."

My throat was completely dry. I had a painful knot in the pit of my stomach. I didn't want to hear anymore. I'd heard too much. An image flashed though my head of my beautiful wife, splayed out in the corner of a

nightclub, getting finger banged by a virtual stranger, her own hands clawing at his crotch.

“Why didn’t you just leave, go his place or something?”

“I couldn’t wait.”

Ugh. *I*. The one word—that one letter—was like a kick in the gut.

“*You* couldn’t wait?” I repeated.

“Nuh uh. Not that he needed a lot of convincing. But...well, after the spectacle we’d been putting on, it wasn’t that surprising that one of the bouncers tracked us down and threw us out.”

“Jeez, baby, you’ve never wanted to have sex with *me* in public,” I said, giving voice to my hurt feelings.

“There are lots of things I’ve only ever done with Chucky.”

“Lots?”

I could see her nodding her head in my peripheral vision. “Lots.”

My mind was racing. I didn’t know how to process all of this. I had no real justification to feel jealous, or angry. But I was both. We’d been married eight years. It still felt like a betrayal somehow.

And also, what was she playing at? Yes, Janet had thrown it out there, and I’d reopened the discussion, but Terri seemed almost gleeful about rubbing my face in it, whatever *it* was.

I jolted upright as I felt her breath, hot and boozy, near my ear.

“You’re not angry with me, are you?” she asked tauntingly as her hand trailed down my chest and into my lap. Her hand closed on my package, and I realized I was already hard. “It doesn’t feel like you’re angry. It feels like you’re turned on to hear about my misbehavior.”

“I’m not.”

She laughed softly. “Mr. Happy disagrees.” She gave my rod a firm squeeze. I felt her pull down my zipper, her head now dipping toward my lap. She fished out my cock and stroked it.

God, road head, so dirty, so dangerous. It had always been a fantasy of mine, though I never mentioned it to Terri.

“Is this another one of those things you’ve only ever done with Chucky?”

“Yup.” She licked up and down the length of my shaft, making me gasp and shiver involuntarily, sending the car swerving into the next lane.

“This is not a good idea,” I groaned.

“Just relax,” she replied, “I have *a lot* of experience at this.”

And with that, she swallowed me deep into her mouth and began bobbing vigorously up and down on my shaft.

I moaned softly, resisting the temptation to close my eyes, forcing myself to stay focused on the road, but that was virtually impossible. It felt so good. Terri was swallowing me deep, her mouth hot, wet, so soft, so inviting.

And at the same time my mind was racing. I wasn't the first man she'd sucked off in a car. She'd done this with Chucky. More than once. Enough times to be have *a lot* of experience. Who was this woman? Where has she come from? And why had she appeared tonight for the first time... for the first time for me, at least.

The thought caused my heart to rise into my throat.

Terri is a sensuous woman, and, of course, oral sex is a regular part of our loving making. She's always good at it, and particularly enthusiastic when she's had a few drinks. But usually nothing like this.

She was bobbing up and down on me like a woman possessed, swallowing me whole, sucking on me so wetly that I could feel her spit flowing onto my balls. And the sound... squishing, loud slurps, passionate moans that reverberated up and down my shaft.

I could barely see straight, and having to concentrate on the road was the only thing that kept me from coming right away. I drove carefully—probably suspiciously slowly—making sure that I neither got pulled over nor crashed into anything. But God, did she make it difficult, blowing me with abandon, her hands rubbing my thighs through my pants.

Luckily it was a short drive. I pulled into the driveway safely and put the car in park.

"We're home," I groaned softly.

"Uh huh," she moaned around my cock, continuing to suck me off, her hand now sliding under my shirt to pinch my nipples.

I closed my eyes and moaned loudly, ostentatiously warning her I was close. She sucked me even deeper.

It was like she wanted me to come in her mouth. I'd never done that. It always seemed demeaning. But then suddenly, I thought of Chucky. I'd never seen him, didn't know what he looked like. He could have been black or Asian or a little person for all I knew. But in my mind's eye, he was broad shouldered Guido, his shirt unbuttoned to his sternum, a gold chain around his neck. He had thick curly hair and an arrogant smirk. I pictured

him easing back his seat, grabbing a big handful of Terri's thick, blond locks, as his fat tool slid deep into her mouth.

I came hard, shuddering. She didn't even flinch. She swallowed my first two spurts easily. Taking just the head of my cock in her mouth, she pumped my shaft up and down with her fist, milking every last drop of cum into her mouth.

As good as it felt, it was still like a slap to the face. The reality of her claim to be experienced suddenly felt very real. She'd done this with Chucky. Blown him numerous times in a car, swallowing his load like a whore—a whore who'd also stripped off her panties in a bar, and fucked a stranger in a bathroom.

God, who was this woman?

“We need to talk,” I mumbled. I opened my eyes just in time to see her yank open her door and slip out of the car and up the path to our house.

It took me a few moments to pull myself together so that I didn't so obviously look like a man who'd just gotten his dick sucked in his driveway, and followed after her.

The first thing that I saw was her black, lacy panties balled up on the floor of the foyer. Then on the stairs, her stiletto pumps, haphazardly discarded. On the second floor landing, her black dress, draped across the carpet like the shed skin of a snake, and then hanging from a closet doorknob, her matching bra.

The door to our bedroom was open, the lights dimmed low.

“Oh God,” I groaned as I walked in.

She was naked, propped up on the bed. Two pillows were wedged beneath her shoulders, and her legs were spread wide, the soles of her feet flat on the sheets of the otherwise stripped bed. Her big tits were pressed together as she reached between her legs with both hands, one spreading her cleanly shaved pussy wide so that I could see the pink wetness within, and the other a blur as it rubbed her clit.

She looked up at me. “What took you so long? Chucky never kept me waiting like this.”

I rocked back on my heels, my emotions racing: anger at being taunted; humiliation at being compared to Chucky; confusion; and most of

all lust. I was rock hard again. I can't even remember stripping off my clothes, but in an instant, I was naked and launching myself at her. No kissing, no foreplay, just my hard prick stabbing wildly at her crotch until the head found her slit. I rammed it home.

She was so wet, so hot, I entered her easily, and took her like a man possessed.

"Ooooh, you *are* angry at me." Her lips curled into an amused smirk.

"Is this how you like it? Is this how Chucky fucked you?" I was aroused, but also angry. Barely in control.

She moaned. She grabbed me around the neck, and put her lips close to my ear. I could feel her breath, coming in ragged gasps, hot, moist, and tinged with the unmistakable aroma of my jism.

"Almost...except he did it harder."

I saw red and snorted like a bull. I rose up on my arms, lifting her head off the pillows as she clung to my neck. I fucked her even faster, sweat dripping from my forehead into the valley between her breasts. Our bodies were slapping together loudly, my dick making obscene squishing sounds as it churned into her wet snatch.

Her lips were still pressed up against my ear. "That's it baby, give it to me good. Fuck me Chucky!"

I grabbed a handful of her hair and wrenched her away from me, forcing her head back onto the bed.

"You're a slut," I hissed.

"Yes!" she groaned in response.

She had her eyes closed now, her hands grasping at her breasts, pinching and pulling on her nipples. She wrapped her legs around my ass.

"Fuck me hard, Chucky, fuck me, oh God, Chucky, fuck meeeeeee...."

She came so hard that she almost bucked me off, her whole body convulsing and her pussy spasming wildly on my cock. I followed immediately after, overwhelmed by her passion.

I was lightheaded. I rolled off her and we both lay there panting. We needed to talk.

But I just needed to catch my breath...

CHAPTER 2:

EXPLANATIONS

I awoke the next morning as a beam of sunlight played across my face. We were naked, spooning, her firm ass against my crotch, my hand wedged between her boobs.

I heard a car door slam and looked at the alarm clock. 10:03 am. Shit, the kids were home.

I shook Terri awake and grabbed my own bathrobe, scrambling down the stairs picking up my wife's discarded clothes as I went. I stuffed her panties into my pocket just the front door opened.

"We brought bagels," my mom cheerfully announced.

"You look like shit," my dad added in a whisper.

He was right. I'd noticed it myself in the hallway mirror. I hadn't had enough to drink to blame it on hangover, but I felt like shit. Part of it was irritation at Terri's revelations. An even bigger part was remorse at my own conduct. Jesus, had I really come in her mouth? Had I really called her a slut? Did I really screw her like one?

She was willing, yes. More than willing. But she was also drunk. And I felt like I'd taken advantage of her in ways that even if she were willing to forgive, I'd have a harder time forgiving myself.

I wanted—needed—to talk to Terri, but the day was a blur. We finally packed off my parents after brunch, but then almost immediately Herb and Melody showed up with their kids for a long-planned cookout. The whole time, I kept looking for an opportunity to take Terri aside, but there was never a free moment.

After they left, we still had a bunch of chores to do: cleaning, laundry, reading to the kids. When the kids finally went down, Terri and I collapsed exhausted into our bed.

"We need to talk," I said simply.

"What about...honey?" she replied with a smirk. For a second, I was sure she was about to call me Chucky again.

"About last night."

“Didn’t you have fun?”

“Yes, but...” I’d had most of the day to think about what was really bothering me, but it was still hard to put into words. “You were so different last night....”

She sighed. “I was drunk. Feeling silly. Also, you kept suggesting I was a prude, and well, in that black dress with guys looking at me, I didn’t feel like a prude.”

“So, what you made that stuff up?”

“No, but I sort of wish I hadn’t said anything.”

That made me feel worse. “No, don’t say that. I don’t want you to feel like you can’t share things with me.”

“So what’s the issue?”

“It’s just, it seems like you were so different with...with him....”

She laughed. “*Him*? What is he, Lord Voldemort? The ex-who-must-not-be-named?”

“Okay, Chucky. You were much, I dunno, um, freer with him. I mean, you had sex with him on the first date...”

She shook her head. “No, it—”

“But last night, you said—” I interrupted.

“It wasn’t a date. He picked me up at a club and scored before we even left.” She continued with that lewd grin.

I shook my head. Who was this woman? “You made me wait, like—”

“Almost three months, I think?”

“Yeah,” I snapped, annoyed now. “What was that about?”

“I liked you.”

I snorted. “Well, then you must have loved him.”

She laughed. “Naw, I thought he was an asshole.”

I shook my head. “So...why?”

“Because he was good looking, funny, and seemed like he might be a good time...” She paused and then gave me that amused, and infuriating, smirk, “... and he was.”

I felt a burst of heat in my cheeks and a vision of Terri writhing beneath Chucky flashed through my head.

“And what was I? Some asshole who had to earn it?”

She shook her head. “No, sweetie, you’re not getting it. I knew right away that Chucky was never going to be more than a fling. So I didn’t care

if he told all his friends that he banged me in a club. That I was just some hot piece of ass.”

“How do you know I don’t say that about you anyway?”

She laughed. “Oh, is that right? Is that what you and Herb were talking about over the grill?” She leaned in close, her voice dropping to a husky whisper. “Did you tell him I sucked you off in the driveway last night? That I swallowed all your come? That I was waiting for you in bed, naked and playing with my hot, wet pussy? That I begged you to fuck me hard?”

She snaked her hand into my pants and stroked my cock, which was surprisingly—to me at least—rock hard.

“No, of course not.”

“That’s because you don’t want people to think I’m a whore. See, the worst thing for a guy, if you’re into a girl, is to end up in the *friend zone*, right?”

I nodded. She was jerking me hard enough to make it hard to talk.

“Well, the worst thing for a girl is ending up in the *whore zone*.”

“But you did end up dating him...I mean, Chucky, didn’t you?”

“Sort of, but it never worked out. Never had a chance. Even if he wasn’t an asshole, he’d have always just seen me as a whore. So we just ended up as friends with benefits...except we were never really friends...just the benefits.”

I shuddered, half from the way she was rubbing my cock head, half from the realization of what she had just said.

“So, what? You were just fuck buddies?”

“Something like that.”

“How’d that... how’d that work?” I stammered.

“Well, some nights he’d get horny and send me a text, and some nights I’d get horny and send him one.”

“And then what? You’d just go over and fuck him?”

She shook her head as if scandalized. “No.” She paused. “Usually, I’d suck his cock first.”

I was dripping pre-cum now, making her handjob sloppier.

“And then what?” I groaned.

“You mean after I sucked his cock? Or after we fucked?”

“Fucked,” I replied, my mouth completely dry.

“Well then I’d go home, silly. Chucky was never one for making a girl breakfast.”

I stared at her wide-eyed.

“Does that bother you, sweetie? Thinking of me getting booty called? Going to a man’s apartment just for sex? Getting fucked silly, and then leaving without even getting cab fare? Does that bother you?”

“Yes,” I grunted, but at the same moment, my cock exploded, drenching her hand and my boxers in jism.

She pulled her hand out of pants and licked her fingers clean.

“Hmmm, talk about a mixed message.” She shot me an amused grin.

“We... we still need to talk,” I stammered.

“We sure do, honey, but not tonight. I’m pretty sure where that would lead, and I’m still sore from last night. So I think we’re going to have to postpone our exploration of my sordid, tawdry, dirty past. So if you don’t mind, I’m going take a shower, and then go to sleep.”

I was speechless. As much because of her explanation as my own reaction to it.

“Okay,” I muttered lamely as she casually stripped off her clothes and walked confidently into the bathroom.

I spent much of the next day trying to make sense of my emotions. There were many things that I didn’t understand. Terri’s *whore zone* and *friend zone* comparison felt, I dunno, just like one of those things women say that sound reasonable, but are just a way to let a man down easy.

I couldn’t avoid comparing her behavior with me with her conduct with Chucky. It wasn’t just how long she’d made me wait; it was also what she’d done with him. That phrase, *there are lots of things I’ve only ever done with Chucky* gnawed at me, especially since every time I replayed it in my mind, the word *lots* became more emphasized, more fraught with meaning. It seemed to cover an endless variety of *sordid, dirty, tawdry* conduct.

The more I thought about it, the more I imagined Terri with Chucky, doing...things... things that I didn’t even dare verbalize to myself. Every crazy, filthy image I’d ever witnessed, and there were a lot after twenty years of viewing porn, I suddenly replayed with my wife and her ex-lover as protagonists.

Worse, I didn't know what to think of it. My emotions were whiplashing back and forth. I was shocked, angry, disappointed to find out she'd been such a dirty slut, even though I didn't even know what she'd actually done—and I wasn't sure I even wanted to know. All I had was my fevered imagination.

And then sometimes, I was just jealous that she wasn't a dirty slut with me. I wanted her to be that girl from the party, blowing me in a car, stripping naked and playing with herself, urging me to fuck her hard.

What the hell did I want? Did I want her to be a *good girl*? Or a *bad girl* but just with me? Or, Jesus, and this was the darkest thing, did I actually like the idea of her having a dark, dirty past. The reality was, I wasn't getting hard thinking of fucking her. I was getting hard imagining her fucking *him*.

CHAPTER 3:

IMPLICATIONS

“We need to talk,” I said as we settled in bed.

She laughed. “Oh God, you’re insatiable.”

“You’re having fun with this,” I replied a little irritably.

“Well, you have to admit, it is funny. I mean, you’re like Pavlov’s dog, except that instead of salivating at the ringing of a bell, you’re popping wood at the sound of the name *Chuck*y.”

“That’s not true.”

“It *is* true.”

I shook my head. I didn’t want to argue the point, especially since deep inside I knew she was right.

“Okay, what are we talking about tonight?” There was that amused smirk again.

I sighed. This wasn’t going like I’d hoped. I’d been on an emotional roller coaster for the last two days. I wanted her to take it more seriously. I wanted her to apologize—or at least act a little embarrassed. But no, she just thought it was funny.

“Damn it, Terri, take this serious. I’m upset.”

She rolled her eyes. “Oh, don’t be so melodramatic. You’re not upset. You’re horny, and you’re freaked out about it because you’re not sure what you’re turned on about.”

“Oh, is that it?”

She nodded.

“Well, sorry to break it to you, but that’s not it. I’m genuinely upset. And you’re not helping.”

“Okay, okay.” She composed her face into a passable approximation of sympathy, but still with that little curl of her lips. “Why are you upset?”

I took a deep breath. “I’m upset because...because of the things you did with *Chuck*y.”

“What things?”

“I...I...I don’t even know,” I stammered. “But you said you did *lots* of things only with him. So maybe we should start with that. What did you do with him?”

“Nuh uh, I’m not going to play *that* game. I’m not going to list sex acts for you to sit there in judgment.”

“Oh, so now you don’t want to talk.”

“I didn’t say that,” she replied. “But I’m not going to sit here and give you a laundry list. I mean, the specific *did I or didn’t I* isn’t the point anyway, is it?”

“No, the point is that you did things with him that you won’t do with me.”

“*Won’t?*” she asked curiously. “What have I ever refused?”

“I...well...” She was right. She’d never actually shot down anything. She always game in her own way. “That’s not the point.”

She smiled. “Of course it is. It takes two to tango.”

“What does that mean?” I grunted, feeling oddly defensive.

She sighed. “Look, I don’t want you to take this the wrong way, because it really isn’t a criticism, I swear. But, well, you’re not the whips and chains kind of guy, are you?”

“Oh, and you are?” I snapped, immediately regretting it. She was obviously much more sexually adventurous than I was. Kindly, she didn’t call me on it.

“No, I’m not,” she replied. “And that’s why we work well together.”

“Well, what about the things you did with Chucky?” A series of depraved acts flashed through my mind.

“Look, half the fun of sex comes from giving pleasure, yes?”

I nodded a bit skeptically.

She continued. “It feels good, of course, but part of what makes it great is seeing your partner enjoying himself.”

I groaned. She seemed to be describing herself as a complete slut, a woman who would do anything she was asked.

“So what, you never say no? Whatever a guy wants, a guy gets?”

Anger flashed in her eyes.

“Listen mister, I’m a skinny blond girl with big tits. I’ve been attracting creeps since I was 13. But here I am, 20 years later, and I can count my sexual partners on the fingers of one hand... well, two hands, but with fingers left over. So don’t make it seem like I’m some roundheel who never said no.”

“But you didn’t say no to Chucky.”

Her smirk returned.

“No, I didn’t.”

“Why? What makes him so special? Did he have a huge cock or something?” I blurted out, immediately wishing I could claw it back.

She giggled. “Oh God, men are crazy. I swear you boys are bigger size queens than any woman I’ve ever met.”

“Well then, what?”

She paused. “I’m not sure, to tell you the truth,” she replied thoughtfully. “He was handsome and funny and confident and older. And I guess it was the right time in my life. I was out of college, on my own. I was trying to find myself. And most of all, I think he seemed safe somehow. The kind of guy who wanted sex in a bar bathroom, but didn’t seem likely to throw your body in a ditch afterwards.”

“That’s it?”

“Yeah, I guess. Would you rather I replied that it was because he was hung like a horse?”

She lunged for me suddenly, her hand rubbing my crotch. I was rock hard. She smiled.

“Was he?” I choked out.

She rubbed my erection up and down. “And what if he was? Would it turn you on to know he was huge?”

“Was he?” I asked again.

She smirked at me again. God I was close. Her hand, her words, that lewd grin...

“No,” she replied softly. “He had a nice cock. Like you. About average, I guess.”

I breathed a sigh of relief. And yet I also felt my excitement fade. It was weird. Was she right? Did I like the idea of her being split open by a porn-sized tool?

She sensed my reaction. Another grin. Then she continued, “Now, his friend Jason, that’s another story.”

“What do you mean,” I asked. “You cheated on Chucky?”

She giggled. “Well, technically, I don’t think you can cheat on a fuck buddy, but no, actually, it was Chucky’s idea. He said he wanted to watch me have sex another man.”

I gasped and felt my shorts fill with hot, sticky jism.

“Oh my.” She felt the wetness spread through my jeans. “Do you see why I think you’re more aroused than upset?”

I looked away, embarrassed. It was humiliating. She was right. I was turned on by the thought of her with another man...men.

“Why don’t you get cleaned up and I’ll tell you the rest of the story.”

I nodded mutely and lumbered into the bathroom. I ducked into the shower, and turned the water up way hot. This had to stop. I didn’t want to hear the rest. I didn’t want to hear anything more. I wanted, more than anything to forget I’d ever heard about Chucky. About the things he’d done with Terri, the things she’d done for him. I didn’t want to know. And yet, even as I repeated that like a mantra, I couldn’t stop the images. And worse, I found I was absentmindedly stroking myself, my erection almost painfully hard.

I turned the temperature to cold, breaking the spell. I stepped out of the shower and dried myself off, changing into a clean pair of boxers to sleep. I was still aroused though as I went back to join Terri in bed. She was wearing a t-shirt. Just a t-shirt I realized as she adjusted herself and flashed me her bare shaven pussy. She patted the bed with her palm.

I climbed in next to her, silently. She took my hand and with her other hand she lifted my chin so that I was looking into her eyes.

“You know this turns me on too, right?”

I looked away.

“I don’t mean talking about Chucky or thinking about the past,” she added hastily. “But seeing you this worked up...it’s hot to realize I can still do that to you.”

She continued, “At first, I regretted saying anything.”

I winced at that. I didn’t like the idea of her keeping secrets either.

“I mean, I was sort of on autopilot that night. And the next day, with your folks and then Herb and Melody around, I kept feeling like I needed to apologize. But then I kept thinking about how excited it got you, and to tell you the truth, I sort of liked having that power over you. I know it makes me sound like a manipulative bitch to admit it, but we’ve been together long enough now that I get a little charge out of pushing your buttons that way.”

“I don’t know what to say,” I muttered.

She smiled. “You don’t have to say anything. Just don’t believe for a minute that I think any less of you for it.”

She took my hand and wedged it between her legs so that I could feel the heat and dampness there. Her other hand slipped into my boxers and

firmly gripped my shaft.

“Shall I tell you about Jason?”

For a moment, I couldn't speak. She'd released my hand and I was now exploring her wet snatch on my own. She moaned softly, squeezing her fingers around my cock in time with my own movements.

“Yes,” I groaned softly.

She smiled.

“I can't believe you had sex with another man just because Chucky told you to.”

“Oh, it wasn't quite like that. I sort of had a crush on Jason. Chucky was always teasing me about me wanting to sleep with his friend. But then again, everybody had a crush on Jason. He's one of those black guys with blue eyes...there's something about that combination that just...mmm. And he was tall, broad shouldered. A complete stud.”

And he had a huge cock, I thought to myself.

“What did Chucky look like? You never told me.”

“Oh, he was good looking, too. Black Irish. Sort of that Dylan McDermott, Daniel Day-Lewis vibe, you know? But Jason...Jason was just dreamy.”

“So why didn't you just go after him yourself?”

“Oh, lots of reasons. I mean, girls were always coming on to him, and I didn't want to be just one of the crowd. And, I dunno, he was a little intimidating, even though he was a really nice guy. Plus, even though Chucky and I weren't *dating* dating, I was sort of his girl.”

“But Chucky liked to tease me about it. He'd catch me stealing a glance at Jason and call me out, bust my chops right in front of him. You know, being an asshole. But then he started encouraging it. During sex, he'd be like, *so are you thinking of Jason?* And then later, he started talking about how he wanted me to do it, how he wanted to watch me having sex.”

She was rubbing my cock harder now, faster.

“We'd be having sex, and he'd be inside me, and he'd be whispering in my ear, *oh baby, you're so hot, I want to watch you getting fucked hard, my own private porno*. I know it sounds creepy, but there was something hot about it.”

“And then,” she continued after a pause, “one night we were hanging out, a group of us, playing pool. I was talking to Jason at one point, and

Chucky came over, put a hand on each of our shoulders and said, *This is it. Tonight's the night you two fuck.*"

As she spoke, I could feel her pussy getting wetter. I slipped a finger inside her, and she rearranged herself so that I could get in deeper. She moaned softly.

"What happened next?" I asked hoarsely.

She smiled. "We laughed it off. You know, it was crazy talk. But Chucky kept working us. I'd see him talking to Jason, looking at me, probably telling Jason what a good lay I was or something. And then he'd come over to me and tell me how good it would be and how much he wanted to see it. And we were still laughing it off. You know, just another *crazy old Chucky* moment. But it must have been working because even as people split off to hit other bars or go home or whatever, we kept hanging around until it was just the three of us left from the group still playing pool.

"And now, Chucky was getting even louder, more insistent about it. And in a weird way, it pushed Jason and me together, the two of us teamed up to try to get Chucky to chill out. Jason was like, *come on dude, cool it, leave her alone.* You know taking my side.

"Anyway, at one point, Chucky got into it again, and I was like, *what even makes you think Jason wants to fuck me?* I don't know why I said it. In my mind, it sounded like a snappy comeback, but looking back it seems desperate, fishing for a compliment or something. Chucky laughed. He goes, *duh, because he's a dude and you have a pulse.* And Jason snorted and shook his head at Chucky. Then he turned toward me and said, *Terri, let me assure you that you are much MUCH more than just a girl with a pulse.*

"I know it doesn't seem like much. But I guess you had to be there. There was this moment between us. We were just looking at each other. It was like the rest of the bar just faded away for a second. And then Chucky goes, *Dude, you gonna shoot at the 8 ball? Or you just gonna bang her right here on the table?* That broke the spell, but after that, I think it was pretty well a foregone conclusion that Jason and I would be having sex that night."

I felt my cock twitch as she said it, and she too seemed to get even more excited. Her breathing was getting raspier. I looked down to see her nipples now pressing at the thin fabric of her t-shirt. We were in a weird place, both of us excited, aroused, together, and yet, somehow, both responding to something which had occurred years ago.

She looked at me. I nodded. I couldn't get the words out, but I needed to hear the rest.

"We went back to Chucky's place. It would have been awkward, but Chucky didn't let it. He had Jason pour us drinks, and then with Jason on the sofa, Chucky stripped me."

I groaned. "He stripped you?"

"Uh huh. I was wearing a little sundress and he just slipped it off my shoulders and let it slide to the floor. I knew Jason was looking at me, but my eyes were locked on Chucky's. Somehow, it was like if I didn't look at Jason, I could deny what was happening. But it went so fast. Chucky unsnapped my bra and pulled it off. I crossed my arms over my boobs just as he bend down to pull off my panties.

"Then he marched me over to Jason. I still couldn't look at him, even when I felt his knees between my thighs, pushing them apart. I was sort of half-straddling him, but still on my feet. Chucky grabbed my hands and pressed them to my sides, and as he did, Jason leaned forward and sucked my nipple hard into his mouth."

Her hand trailed over her left nipple absentmindedly as she recalled the moment. I shivered with excitement.

Then she continued. "I gasped and Chucky chuckled approvingly. *That's it man*, he encouraged, *suck on those big tits*. I finally looked down at Jason, and he was looking up at me with those luscious blue eyes, his mouth on my breast. I moaned and Jason pulled off for a moment and with a big smile said, *I've been wanting to do this forever*."

Terri peeled off her t-shirt and climbed into my lap. I could feel her heat, her wetness through my boxers. I was hard again. My cock strained against the fabric. She cupped her breasts, her nipples dark red and erect, and offered them to me. "Do you want to suck on them like Jason did?"

I nodded mutely and took her nips into my mouth, one at a time, going back and forth, feeling her squirming with delight.

"That's it, honey," she moaned. "That's just how he did it. He got me so excited. So hot."

She let me suck her nipples for several minutes, until they were swollen, her areolae waxy and puffy. She reached down and wrenched down my boxers, just enough to free my cock, which sprung to attention in my lap. Finally she continued.

“Then I felt Chucky’s hands on my shoulders, pushing down firmly, pressing me into Jason’s lap. And between my legs, I could feel Jason’s cock, engorged, rigid. I was so wet, it, it just slid into me.”

And with that, she slowly lowered herself on my own cock, her pussy so wet, so ready, just like it must have been that evening with Jason.

“It just slid into me,” she repeated. “Deeper and deeper and deeper. He was so big, so thick. I’d never...” she paused and looked me straight in the eye as she settled into my lap. “I’ve never felt anything like it since.”

I couldn’t help it. I exploded deep inside her. Not as deep as Jason had been, I reflected, but as deep as I could go. And immediately, I blushed red, too embarrassed to look at Terri, frustrated that I kept coming so fast, cognizant that ever since this game had begun, I’d been taking my pleasure in microseconds and leaving Terri high and dry.

“I’m sorry,” I groaned miserably, desperate to free myself from this embrace, wanting nothing more than to crawl under a rock.

But she refused to move. “Shhh, baby, shhh, it’s okay, it’s okay,” she whispered reassuringly. “Just sit still.”

I relaxed and nodded at her, and even though I could feel my cock softening, shrinking, my jism now leaking into my lap, by not moving, the tip stayed inside her, prolonging our embrace.

“There’s more,” she said after another few moments.

“More?”

“Uh huh. You didn’t think it just ended like that, did you? Me naked in a room with two men, full of the biggest cock of my life...that sound more like a beginning than an ending doesn’t it?”

I couldn’t speak. I swallowed hard.

“So...what happened?”

“What do you think happened?”

“I...I don’t know.”

“But you have some ideas, don’t you?”

“They fucked you. Both of them.”

She smiled. “Yes, but not right away. At first, it was just me and Jason. He started thrusting, driving that big cock into me from below, with Chucky urging him on.”

“Did you come?”

She shook her head. “No, not then. It felt really good,” she sighed, “but it was just too weird. Especially with Chucky directing.”

“Directing?”

“Yeah, remember this was his idea. He wanted to see Jason banging me, you know, so he kept telling Jason to fuck me harder. Then he had Jason ragdoll me.”

I gave her a quizzical look.

“You know, like throw me around, bouncing me in his lap.”

“Did you like that?”

“Mmmm, it was pretty intense, but yeah, I guess. It’s hard to explain, and it’s not for everyday, but there is something about that kind of rough, dominant sex that can be hot. Being taken that way.”

I groaned. There was something about the word *taken* that just set me off. I realized that while I wasn’t hard yet, there was definitely something going on. I wasn’t at any risk of slipping out of Terri anymore. She must have realized it as well because she starting moving slowly, rocking her hips, grinding against me.

“He had Jason flip me onto my back on the sofa. Chucky grabbed my ankle and lifted it high in the air, spreading me completely open. Jason was thrusting deeper and deeper. I had my hand on his abdomen to slow him down. I didn’t think I could take it all. God, baby, you should have heard me, I don’t think I’ve ever been louder in my life. And that only seemed to get them both more excited. Chucky reached down and pulled my hand away, and Jason plunged in deeper and deeper, until finally, he was completely inside me.”

I could picture it my mind. My lovely Terri, naked, spread open, exposed, a huge cock buried inside her. I could imagine the look on her face, a mixture of excitement and concern, but mostly just lust. It took me a moment to realize she’d stopped talking and was now just looking at me, waiting for a reaction. My thoughts were hazy. I felt drunk. And I found I could barely speak. She raised an eyebrow.

“That’s hot,” I moaned softly.

“It was,” she agreed. “But it doesn’t end there. I mean, you realize Chucky had sex with me too that night.”

I nodded. Of course.

“They put on me on the floor, on my hands and knees, and Jason took me from behind.”

I moaned again. Terri usually didn’t like that. She always said it wasn’t intimate enough for her. But it was my favorite position. Her tight little ass

in the air, her big boobs swaying beneath her, her long blond hair draped down back. I didn't ask for it often out of respect, but thought about it all the time.

"Then Chucky took off his clothes and stood in front of me. He grabbed my hair and pressed his cock into my mouth."

I let out another involuntary moan. I was rock hard again.

"You're a dirty boy, aren't you?" she teased. "Getting all worked up thinking of me with those two men. Imagining your innocent little wife getting spit roasted by a couple of brutes."

"You're not innocent," I grunted.

She smiled. "No, I wasn't that night, that's for sure."

She was fucking me slowly now, rising up and down on my shaft, her pussy drenched from her excitement and my jism. It felt sloppy and thankfully a little loose or I would have come again right away.

"Does that feel good?" she moaned.

"Hmmm, yeah."

She worked me expertly, slowly lifting herself up until just the tip of my cock was inside her. She dropped down, impaling herself hard on me. And yet, as good as it felt, all I could think of was her, on her knees, two men taking her, using her.

"I haven't told you the dirtiest part yet," she sighed. "After a few minutes, they switched sides."

"Oh God," I groaned.

"Yeah, right," she replied with a sheepish grin. "Jason was, um, too big for me to do much, but I licked him up and down."

Licked up her own juices. I pictured them, laughing, grinning at my wife, so submissively servicing them both. Did they think her a whore? Or were they too busy just using her for their pleasure to think about it?

And still she rode me, harder now, faster, reaching back to spread her ass cheeks so that she could take me even deeper.

"How did it end?"

"It didn't, not right away. They switched back and forth again, and then finally Jason finished inside me. That really turned Chucky on. He flipped me onto my back and, well, I'd never seen him like that. Just wild. He came too. Then we move into the bedroom, and, you know, we sort of went back and forth until we fell asleep."

Her last sentence hinted at a conclusion, but her body was sending another signal. She was still riding me, but now her eyes were closed, her breaths raspy, her whole body exuding a raw sensuality.

“What are you thinking of?” I asked.

She stopped moving, opened her eyes and looked at me.

“Jason.” She replied simply.

I nodded. She was asking permission for something, and instinctively I’d just given it.

She closed her eyes again and began moving on me, riding me, but not really riding *me*. She was just using me to relive her own memories.

“I woke up.... I heard a noise.... Out in the living room....” Her voice was deep, throaty, each fragment punctuated with a groan. “I went to him.... Jason... He was dressed.... Leaving.... I.... I stopped him.... Took him by the hand.... Back to the sofa.... Stripped.... Pulled him on me.... We....ugh....made love.... Long.... Slow.... Kissed....”

She leaned forward and kissed me, or him, whatever. Passionate soul kisses.

“So deep.... So good.... So long.... Just the two of us.... On that sofa.... Oh Jesus!”

She threw her head back. Her whole body shuddered. Her pussy spasmed on my cock. I’d never seen her come so hard. I knew it wasn’t me. I hadn’t done anything. She’d been thinking about her own past adventures. And the realization of that was too much. I came too, filling her with my jism.

We melted together. Silent.

CHAPTER 4:

ADMISSIONS

Here's the thing. When I first met Terri, the attraction was purely physical, at least for me. The blond hair, the big rack, that impossibly small waist, she was—still is—a Barbie Doll. She had the look of a spoiled sorority girl, the kind of girl you take for a ride, but not the kind you bring home to mother.

I probably would have *whore-zoned* her in a heartbeat if she'd put out right away. We met at an after-work kick-ball game, ended up at a bar for a few drinks. She was surprisingly fun to talk to, we shared a similar taste in movies, and an interest in foodie topics. But the reality was that my main interest was getting my hands on those titties.

I was disappointed when she turned down my offer for a nightcap. I'd been sure she was the kind of girl who'd be, as my buddies used to say at the time, DTF—*down to fuck*. I was only mildly mollified when she gave me her number instead. I almost threw it away in frustration, but instead I tucked it into my pocket, and after whacking it that night thinking of her, I texted and invited her out to dinner instead.

I was sure I'd score on that second date. But I didn't. All I got was a hug and a kiss on the cheek. Third date was surely the magic number, but even when I made it clear that my interests were more than platonic, she deftly deflected my efforts to get more intimate.

She was definitely interested, though. Sharing more, acting flirty enough to make it clear she had a romantic interest as well, texting me promptly, but still keeping me at arms length.

I realized I'd been wrong about her. She was a good girl. And not just that, but she was genuinely fun to be with. I'm not going to say she was my *soul mate*, or that I knew I was falling in love. But I was.

It went on for a couple of months. We were kissing now. Holding hands in public. Cuddling. But still no sex. She didn't seem particularly sheltered or prudish or frigid or religious. There didn't seem to be any particular trauma in her past. She wasn't dark or moody, not afraid of our growing attachment, she just wasn't putting out.

I remember telling a buddy, *I think she might be a virgin*. He'd just rolled his eyes, *Damn, that'd be a waste, that body was made for fucking*.

Terri and I had grown close enough that I bridled at his comment. He grinned and chuckled knowingly. I was smitten.

I took her to a Sarah McLachlan concert in the park. We sat huddled together against the night chill and shared a bottle of wine, and then a second. We kissed, slowly, tenderly, endlessly, the music just a background, the crowd around us fading into nothingness.

We packed up our things, folding my old blanket into my knapsack, chucking out the empty bottles. We walked back toward my place, a little unsteadily, giggly, pressed up against each other. I didn't even think to invite her up, just assumed she would come. We were there—past there—past any possible reason not to spend the night together. I released her to unlock the door to my building, and as I did, she slid back, away from me on the sidewalk, hand on her hip, an enigmatic grin on her face.

I remember standing there, suddenly adrift. I didn't know what to say. She leaned in and gave me a kiss on the cheek. *Soon*, she whispered in my ear. Then she turned and walked away, a playful skip in her step.

I was shocked, then disappointed, then pissed. I didn't call or text for a couple of days. And she didn't either. And then, just as my resolve was breaking down, just as I was about to make a fool of myself with some sort of maudlin declaration, she let me off the hook.

She invited herself over and pulled me into the bedroom. We made love. Well, not really. The first time was awkward, and quick, just an act of copulation to break the ice. But she didn't seem disappointed or surprised. And when we did it again, it was tender, loving. She was no virgin, certainly. She was too self-assured and generous for that.

We've been together ever since. We moved in together in a matter of months. We were engaged soon thereafter. She was a ravishing bride, later a glowing expectant mother, a companion, a life mate, a woman I could not imagine existing without.

And yet, there had never been that moment of crazy passion. We'd never just, for lack of a better word, fucked. No instance of crazy, sweaty, reckless, hungry sex. She was right, I was never a whips and chains kind of guy, but even still, I'd always been restrained—felt constrained by my view of her as a good girl, not a prude necessarily, but surely conservative.

I had dreamed of things early on. Dirty thoughts. Titty fucking. Coming in her mouth, on her face. Spanking her ass. But out of respect—respect for her as a *good girl*—I'd never mentioned it, never explored it.

And over time, those fantasies shifted to other women: actresses, waitresses, interns, random women on the street, porn stars. I still had dirty, demeaning thoughts about women sometimes—what man doesn't? But never about Terri. And anyway, they were just thoughts. Just silly immature fantasies, right?

And now suddenly I was confronted with the reality that my wife, the mother of my children, was not just the object of other men's fantasies, but that she had, in real life, been that kind of girl. She'd had hook ups, sex with strangers. She'd fucked men in bathrooms, blew men in cars, swallowed their come. She'd had sex in public. She'd been tag-teamed. She'd been a dirty whore. Just never with me.

It never occurred to me to leave her. I wasn't mad. This wasn't some "issue" to overcome. That wasn't what this was all about. It's just that after all these years, we were in a routine. It was comfortable, enjoyable. Her stories about Chucky were an invitation to explore our relationship, push the envelope, but the reality was, I wasn't sure I wanted that.

The thought of my wife being "taken," "spit roasted," "ragdolled," bent over a bathroom sink, fingered at a bar, all of it was insanely hot—hot the moreso for being something that she enjoyed. But it wasn't anything I could do to her, not to my wife, not to the mother of my children, not after so many years. It wasn't that we were in a rut. It was just that we'd taken a different path.

The problem was that the neat boxes that I tried to establish in my mind between fantasy and reality were frustratingly permeable. There were just too many triggers.

A scene from a movie, a sexy woman walking across my office lobby, or even just distracted daydreaming, and before I knew it I was thinking of Terri in some sort of sexual situation. Every time I saw a man who could have passed for her description of either Chucky or Jason, I'd suddenly picture her with them. Whenever we were apart, I couldn't help but wonder if she was doing something sexual. Was she banging her boss? Her personal trainer?

The good news was that we were having more sex, nightly in fact, which was a big change from our previous, happily married, once or twice a

week routine. After putting the kids down, as if by mutual agreement, we'd rush through evening chores and climb into bed naked.

Terri didn't mention Chucky or the stories. She didn't need to. She knew what was going on in my mind, or at least part of it. Her amused grin as she watched me hurriedly folding laundry before bed spoke volumes. As did her little asides, her comments about how *amorous* I was recently, or her observation that I seemed to be going to bed earlier and earlier.

I tried to avoid the subject. I didn't want to confront the shame of being helplessly turned on by my wife's past. Well, no, that's not true. I was confronting it daily, hourly, each time we made love, each time I pictured Terri with another man. What I wasn't ready to do was admit it to Terri.

And yet, the pressure was building. I had to know what she was thinking. Was she also thinking of Chucky... and her past... all the time? Now that we'd broken the seal on revisiting that part of her life, did she crave it again? Did she think of them, of other men, when we had sex? Was she as obsessed as I was?

In some ways I hoped she was. It would make my reaction somehow more "normal." But the thought of it made me desperately jealous. Could I live with her admission that she was thinking about another man in our most intimate moments?

It's funny, but Terri and I never had "the talk." We never talked about our past loves. When Terri mentioned that she could count her lovers on her fingers and have fingers left over, that was news to me. Until recently, I'd barely heard Chucky mentioned, and I knew nothing from before then. I didn't even know when she'd lost her virginity.

It seems absurd now, but as we started dating, I consciously avoided the talk. She was so wholesome that I didn't want to freak her out. After all, I'd been with five (count 'em five!) women before Terri, including a couple of drunken one night stands, and I was worried about what such a revelation would do to such a delicate creature.

But it seemed as if now was a good time to broach it.

Terri was sitting in bed finishing up some office work. She's a health care consultant, working with families to develop appropriate plans to deal with difficult situations: a special needs kid, an elderly parent with

Alzheimer's, that kind of stuff. The pay isn't great, but Terri loves the satisfaction of working with and helping families so much that she often brings work home. Finally, she finished up and put away her laptop.

"Terri, we need to talk."

She laughed. "Oh God, Chucky again? Even he'd be embarrassed by how much we talk about him, and he's a narcissist."

"No, not Chucky. I want to talk about your other lovers."

"Bill, baby, I love you, but you're getting obsessed. It's fun. But, are we sure this is healthy?"

"Yes," I replied firmly. I'd already practiced my response. "It's just about getting everything out on the table. You know, we never actually talked about this when we were first dating."

"Oh, so this is about mutual revelations? I'll finally get to hear about Melanie?"

"What? Oh sure..."

My Mom, bless her soul, had a glass of wine too many one Thanksgiving early on and spent a good five minutes rhapsodizing about one of my exes, Melanie, and in particular Melanie's skill at making fruit pies. I think that Terri and I had just moved in together. It was a silly little thing, but I can still remember Terri quietly fuming at the table and then giving me the cold shoulder for the rest of the meal.

"Wow, you have a good memory," I laughed.

"Well, your mom did spend like half an hour basically grieving over having missed out on her as a daughter-in-law and getting stuck with me instead."

"You're exaggerating."

"Am not. Your mom had a picture up of you and her at some prom or something until Braden was born. I guess she realized she wasn't getting rid of me then and took it down."

"My mom doesn't hate you."

"No, she just liked Melanie better."

I sighed. "I think we're getting off track."

"Yes," Terri replied, "that can happen when you revisit the past."

"Touché...but I don't have any deep dark secrets, and anyway, it's the past we're talking about. And since we've been talking about it anyway, we might as well have some, I dunno, context."

She began to answer, but then paused thoughtfully. "Okay, you first."

“Um, okay.”

“Wait,” she said holding up her hand. “So this is just relationships with sex?”

“Well, yeah...but oral counts.”

“Okay. How about handjobs? Dry-humping, or frottage, as you may know it?” she asked in a high-toned, Park Avenue accent.

I sighed. “You’re mocking me.”

She laughed. “I’m sorry, I’m sorry. I just wanted to make sure we were on the same page. Okay,” she continued, barely suppressing her mirth, “you show me yours and I’ll show you mine.”

I groaned. Not a one of these conversations had turned out like I’d expected. Part of it was Terri, who seemed perpetually amused at my earnestness. Part of it was that it was easier to imagine the conversation in the abstract than to actually say the words. This problem struck me particularly as I tried to think about how to begin my revelations.

Terri seemed to recognize my problem. “Maybe this would be easier over a glass of wine? I’ll go get us a couple.”

She got up and scooted out the door and down the stairs and a few minutes later returned with two glasses and an uncorked bottle of Chardonnay. She poured a couple of glasses and handed one to me. Then she sat back and gave me an expectant look.

I took a sip, well more of a gulp, and cleared my throat.

“Okay, well, my first girlfriend...”

“Lover, you mean,” Terri interjected. “If we’re going to do this, we might as well dispense with the euphemisms.”

“Okay. Fine. The first woman with whom I had sexual intercourse was April.”

Terri giggled, “Please God, tell me the second was named May.”

“And the third June? Sorry, no such luck. Anyway, I was 18. Then the second...”

“Whoa, whoa, whoa. Slow down cowboy. I need details. What did she look like? How did it happen?”

“I...okay,” I replied, both put out and a little grateful. I knew I’d want details from her, so had to provide them myself, but somehow discussing ex-girlfriends, lovers, was more difficult than I’d imagined.

“So, I went to an all boys school. Not much of a chance to date or whatever. April was this girl I met the summer after senior year. I was

working in a bike shop, she was working at the Limited across the street. She looked a little like Janet, now that I think about it. Well, same red hair anyway. We'd have lunch together, then went to a couple of parties. We messed around a little, but didn't have sex over the summer. Timing never quite worked out right, and anyway, college was coming down the pike and I was sure that would be a veritable orgy, so I didn't want to get tied down."

I chuckled ruefully. "Anyway, college wasn't an orgy. And I'd been keeping in touch with April, emailing and such, and she'd sort of become my *out of town* girlfriend to the guys at school and I was sort of believing it myself. Back before school started, we'd talked about visiting each other, and now I started working it, sort of inviting myself for a visit. So I drove up to visit, and well, I sort of wheedled sex out of her."

Terri raised an eyebrow. "Wheedled?"

I shuddered a little. "Yeah, not my proudest moment. She'd been a virgin when we met, and that was one reason why we didn't have sex over the summer. But by the time I came to visit she had cashed in her v-chit, so I basically guilted her into having sex with me. Told her I'd been saving myself for her, that kind of stuff."

"Meanwhile, you'd have banged any willing girl yourself," Terri said with a laugh.

"I was 18. Anyway, my first time was basically pity sex or something."

"So you never saw her again?"

I shook my head. "Nope. Drove up, badgered her for three hours, gave her 90 seconds of bliss and then left."

Terri laughed. "I always knew you were a true romantic."

"Okay, you," I replied.

"Ugh. Okay. I was sixteen," she said with an embarrassed pout.

"That's not so bad," I replied.

"No, I guess not. Anyway, there was this guy, Alex. Lived in my neighborhood. I dunno, he might have been one of my brother's friends at one point. He was older. Nineteen. Had a beat up junker and a band. Just the right combination to peak the interests of a sixteen-year-old girl. The fact that his band never left his garage and the fact that the garage was his folks' because he still lived at home never factored in."

"Well, you were living at home too," I offered sympathetically.

"No, I know. But just such a cliché, right?"

"I guess."

“Well, naturally they had a sofa set up so people, girls I guess, could watch the band. Lost my virginity right on that nasty sofa in Alex Tremanian’s garage.”

“So, what was this like a one-time thing?”

“Oh, no, far from it. Jesus, where were my parents? I swear, when Annabelle is sixteen, I’m going to have her on a leash.”

I laughed. “Good idea.”

Annabelle was obviously taking after her mom in the looks department, same blue eyes and blond hair.

“Anyway, after school, every day, I’d go over to Alex’s, or he’d pick me up at school sometimes and drive me home. And then we’d fool around. Then I’d do a little homework while he messed around with his guitar. Then more sex.”

“Every day?”

“You know, more or less. Unless I had some other activity. But yeah, pretty much. He was nineteen, I was sixteen. It’s not like it was anything real accomplished.”

“God I’d have killed for that kind of set up.”

She laughed. “Yup, I hope he kicks himself everyday thinking about how he blew it.”

“Oh?”

She laughed again. “Oh, well, you know, I was so fucking full of myself, right? I was the bee’s fucking knees. I had myself an older guy. A musician. Take that all you stupid sophomore girls and your dumb-ass jock boyfriends. And I was bragging about how mature he was, what a great lover he was...”

“Was he?”

“God no. I mean, believe me, we were young and limber, so we tried all sorts of things, but let’s just say he was getting a lot more out of it than I was. But you know, at sixteen, you don’t really know what to expect.

“Anyway, I’d bragged so much to my friend,” she said that with a sneer, “Chrissy, that bitch, she decided to try it out.”

“With Alex?”

She nodded.

“How’d you...”

“I walked in on them, of course. That was fun. Crying. Screaming. The two of us yelling at each other.”

“Oof.”

“Oh, it gets better. See, I wasn’t about to lose him to her, so you know, I kept having sex with him. More often even. Until I caught him with another friend. And even then I kept going over to his place for a while until I finally wised up. But of course, the minute I dumped him, so did Chrissy and Claire, so he went from banging three sixteen year olds to none.”

“I’m sure he still did fine.”

“I don’t think so. The window on getting naive teenage girls is small. Nineteen and in a band is cool. Twenty-two and still living in mom’s basement, not so much.”

I nodded. The story piqued my interest, but I didn’t find it as titillating as what she’d told me about Chucky. Maybe it was because she was younger, and it felt skeevey to be turned on. Maybe it was just because it wasn’t really that surprising. It’s about the story I expected. Slightly older guy, cool for many of the wrong reasons. And yet, it did foreshadow things with Chucky. The casual attitude toward sex, and the use of sex as some sort of validation from an older man.

“Okay, your turn again,” she prompted.

Ugh, I thought. This was a bad one. My one night stand.

“Okay. Well, in college now. Spring of freshman year. I went to a frat party, met this older girl, a sophomore, maybe a junior. Curly hair. We were drunk. Started making out at the party. We went back to her dorm and had quick, awkward sex in one of the common rooms. Never saw her again. I don’t even know her name.”

Terri scrunched up her face. “That’s it?”

“That’s my number two. You?”

She sighed. “You sure we want to do this?”

I could see her point. My first two sex partners had amounted to two sex acts. Her first had comprised hundreds. “Sure. We’re just getting everything out on the table.”

“It’s just that I’m beginning to feel like my table might be a little more crowded than yours.”

I felt that twinge again. Jealousy and excitement. Until a few weeks ago, I was carrying around this notion that I was more experienced than Terri, that she was sheltered enough that I needed to worry about how she’d react to skimpily-attired women at a nightclub. I was now coming to realize that she had more ability to shock me than I to shock her.

“It’s okay,” I replied gently, even though my insides were twisting at the thought of more revelations.

She took a deep breath. “Okay, I was still in high school. Senior year now. Another older guy. I guess I felt I was too good for high school boys or something. Anyway, I met Danny at Thanksgiving. My mom had invited one of her recently divorced co-workers to our house, and she brought along her son who was back from college for the holiday. He was really cute, but also smart, and we hit it off.”

“You didn’t? At Thanksgiving?”

She laughed. “No. We just, you know, flirted like crazy. But I thought about it. I hadn’t had sex in a year. But I was still a good girl, I guess. Anyway, this was before texting, right? But I think I had an AOL account, or maybe Hotmail? So we emailed back and forth. And when he came back for Christmas break we hooked up.”

“What, like once?”

She shook her head. “Naw. We were pretty much inseparable. He was much more, um, attentive than Alex. But you know, it was just a temporary thing. I mean, he was going back to school, and even though we talked about me coming up to visit, there was no real way to make that happen. My parents were pretty hands off—”

“I’ll say.”

She shrugged. “But even still, they wouldn’t have been cool with their high school daughter traveling across the state just to get laid.”

“So that was it?”

“Oh no. I mean, I was in love, or at least I thought I was. God, I was so jealous. I kept making him promise he wasn’t seeing other girls at school. He came home again for President’s Day or something. And then I got so pissed off when he decided to go to Florida with some buddies for spring break instead of coming to see me again. That should have been a real big hint, right?”

I nodded. Experienced college man or not, no guy would have passed up an opportunity to hook up with Terri unless he had other irons in the fire, so to speak.

“So what happened?”

“I gave him an ultimatum...and then he dumped me.”

“I’m sorry,” I said absurdly.

She grinned. “You’re too sweet for your own good some times.”

I blushed. She was right. What had I said that?

“Okay, your turn again.”

“Melanie. My first real girlfriend. So I had a long dry spell after frat party girl. All of sophomore year, actually, and the summer after. But I used one of my electives to take an English class. Part of it was clearing my arts requirement, but I definitely picked British Romantic Poetry in part because I thought it might be a good way to meet chicks.”

Terri laughed. “And it worked?”

“Yup. A five-one female-male ratio paid off. I feel gay to admit it, but I actually enjoyed it. Great prof.”

“Yeah?”

“A thing of beauty is a joy for ever,” I said.

“Shelley?”

“Keats,” I corrected.

“You’ve never recited poetry for me.”

“And you’ve never dropped your panties in my lap.”

“Touché.” She paused. “So, what, you guys sat around and quoted couplets at each other?”

“Well, at least until I got her naked.”

Terri rolled her eyes. “You guys are so mercenary.”

It was my turn to shrug my shoulders.

“So what happened?”

“We dated. Whatever that means in college. I guess I took her out occasionally. Mostly we just hung out. She stayed over at my place a couple of times a week. I was living with some buddies off-campus. We were together most of junior year, then senior year. Went to the senior week gala together. That’s the picture you saw at my mom’s.”

“So what made her so special besides your shared love of poetry and her pies?”

“We were good together. No drama. I dunno. It’s hard to explain.”

“What happened?”

I paused. I’d thought of this before, of course. Before I met Terri, Melanie was my one real relationship. But it was hard to put into words. “I dunno. We got too old too young. I know that doesn’t make any real sense. But that was it. She went to grad school out East. I wasn’t ready to commit, to move just to be with her, and she wanted to focus on school. At first, we just called it a break. You know, like we’d get back together. But I dunno,

neither of us really did anything to make that happen. I made plans at one point to come out to see her, but something came up. Maybe I had a job interview? Anyway, we cancelled and never rescheduled. Then, you know, we both started getting interested in other people. Or at least interested in getting interested.”

“Sounds like it just faded away.”

“Yeah, I guess.” Thinking of it made me a little melancholy, though I wasn’t sure why. Perhaps, more than anything, it was realizing how little it had affected me at the time, how little I was in touch with my emotions—and hers—back then.

“You okay?”

I smiled. “Yeah, it’s sometimes weird thinking about the past, though, isn’t it? Feels like being a spectator on your own life, and you don’t even really understand the protagonist.”

She tilted her head and regarded me thoughtfully. “You surprise me sometimes, Bill.”

“How?”

“I dunno. I just...I just get the sense that you keep a lot inside.”

I shrugged. Don’t we all? “Maybe. Okay, your turn. What are you up to? Number three?”

“I’ll do three and four at the same time...”

I raised an eyebrow.

“I don’t mean it like that,” she said with a laugh. “Just, you know, similar situations. Two different guys. Maybe six months apart. Danny and then Buck. Met Danny in class. Buck was, I guess, a friend of a friend. Hung out for a while together, then ended up hooking up. In both cases, it was similar. A period of flirtation, group activities, then some solo time. Lots of sex for a week or so, and then both just sorta of trailed off.”

“Why?”

“Danny was a real quiet guy. Smart but a little boring. After a little while, it sort of felt like I’d heard all his stories, ya know? And to tell the truth, the sex was blah.”

“How so?”

“Well, his cock was just too small.”

I nearly choked on my spit. “Really?”

She nodded, but couldn’t keep a straight face. Cracking up, she came clean. “No, good grief. We just didn’t work well together. No chemistry.”

“And Buck?”

“He was a senior. He didn’t want to commit to anything. And even though I didn’t either, I dunno, he made me feel like I was an afterthought. Sometimes things just don’t work out, right?”

I nodded. “Okay. I guess I’m up to four as well. This was another short fling. Met a girl at a house party after I moved back down here. One thing led to another. We ended up at her place. She had roommates, but even still I spent the weekend, mostly in bed, except to grab food.”

“Name?”

I laughed. “This one I remember. Sheila. She looked a lot like you in a lot of ways, petite, blond...except not as pretty.”

Terri laughed. “Ah, you’re sweet. Or is that just code for *she had smaller boobs?*”

“She didn’t hold a candle to you in any way.”

“So what happened?”

“Nothing. I mean, it was fun and all, but no real connection beyond the sex, and even the sex was, as you said about Danny, blah.”

“Okay five,” she paused and blushed a little. “I, um, was the other woman with a married man. I was interning in the front office of a managed care facility. He was my boss. Handsome, older guy. Gary Tehern. He was so interested in me.”

“I bet.”

“No,” she shook her head. “That’s not what I mean. That’s the thing. Unlike most guys—even you,” she added pointedly, “he wasn’t like that. I never caught him checking out my boobs or my ass. No cheesy come-ons, no double entendres. He was just interested in *me*. He was encouraging, helpful, praised me when I did a good job, constructive when I screwed up. He just...seemed to want me to succeed. It’s hard to explain why that was so important to me. But it was.”

She must have seen the doubt in my eyes.

“I know what you’re thinking. And you’re probably right. It was all a big act. We did end up in bed together. Maybe that’s what he intended all along. But, I know this is hard for guys to understand, or even, and I hate to say this, plainer girls to understand, but with my looks...” she paused, a little embarrassed. “I’m not saying I’m that hot, but I just have a look that guys always go for.”

I nodded.

“Well, it is hard to explain how rare that is and how much I appreciated the fact that he was so proper, so professional toward me. He treated me like a protégé, not a kid, and most importantly, not just a hot chick. And of course, I fell for him as a result. I knew I shouldn’t. I knew I’d ruin everything, but I couldn’t help myself. And he, well, he didn’t have a chance.”

She blushed again.

“Oh God, that sounds so awful, like I’m irresistible.”

“Well...”

“I’m not, you know. There’s plenty of guys who have turned me down.”

“Yeah?”

She blushed.

“You don’t need to apologize, honey. I find you irresistible. And, well, truth is, there are not a lot of middle-aged married men who could or would be able to resist a pretty college coed.”

“Are you saying you’d cheat on me if a 22 year old blonde hit on you?”

“No, course not. I mean, first of all, 22 year old blondes don’t hit on me, and anyway, I have a hot, blond piece of ass at home already.”

“You’re such a charmer.”

“I try.”

“Well, Gary and I were working late. I don’t even know why I was there. I mean, I was just an intern. But, I guess I was looking for any excuse to spend time with him. He was showing me something on the computer, and I was leaning over his shoulder. And I kissed him. Pure impulse, although I’d been thinking about for a long time.”

She paused.

“And then what happened?”

“We had sex right there on the desk.”

“Are you kidding?”

She shook her head. “This time I’m not.”

“Sounds like he was pretty into it.”

“Well, yeah, I guess. Although, you know, at first he was all like, *we can’t do this, this is a bad idea*, and stuff like that. And then after we were done, it was the same thing. Lots of apologizing and regrets. None of which stopped us from doing it again right after.”

I groaned softly. There was something undeniably erotic about the scene she painted. I could imagine her perched on his desk, him standing between her widely spread legs, sliding his cock deep inside her as they kissed passionately. She was probably still dressed. Her skirt hiked up, panties pulled to the side, her blouse hanging open, bra pushed up to expose her big boobs. And then immediately after, after the sex, after the initial awkwardness, had she dropped to her knees? Sucked him hard so he could bang her again?

"I can see in your eyes that the idea of me seducing my much older boss is a turn on. Why?"

"I dunno. Part of it, I guess, is that until recently I never imagined you'd do something like that. And part of it is that some of your stories are just so wanton, at least how I imagine them. And part of it is it sometimes sounds like you're just overwhelmed with passion, can barely control yourself."

She nodded. "It's not something I'm proud of. But you're right. There have been times, with Alex, with Gary, with Chucky where the connection seemed so intense that I was reckless in pursuing it. Dangerous, stupid."

"Maybe part of what turned you on was the recklessness."

"Maybe. God, Gary and I were so stupid. We couldn't be seen out in public together, so we just hooked up at the office. A couple, three times a day we'd lock ourselves into his office. We were 'working late' almost every night. Laughing at private jokes. So fucking obvious. The office gossips were on it immediately. Then his wife found out."

"How?"

"Oh, jeez, one of the secretaries ratted us out. His wife already suspected, of course, but she'd been in denial. Anyway, she threw him out of the house, which tore him up because they had kids. The secretaries were calling me a whore, a home-wrecker, not even quite behind my back. The office manager called me in and cancelled my internship. Then Gary lost his job, too, although they gave him three months to find another position. Just a complete clusterfuck."

"Did you continue to see him?"

"Just at the beginning, when things were just starting to unravel. There was still something intoxicating about it, you know, sort of *us against the world*. But that didn't last long. The distance between rebel and loser is smaller than I would have guessed. It stopped being fun then."

“Anyway,” she continued. “That’s it for me. After Gary, it was Chucky, Jason, and you. I’ve been with eight men altogether. Finish up.”

“My last isn’t exciting. Janice was a set-up. Mutual friends did some matchmaking. We went out a few times, ended up sleeping together for a couple of months. I was looking for ways to end it when she did me the favor of pulling the plug on it. Weird thing is, even though I’d been thinking of ending it myself, I took it hard when she dumped me. Silly, right?”

Terri didn’t say anything for a while, and neither did I. Finally she took my hand.

“So Bill, did you get out of this talk what you wanted?”

“I didn’t want anything in particular.”

She regarded me skeptically.

“Well, at least I don’t know what I wanted. But nothing you’ve told me makes me feel differently about you.”

“Okay,” she replied. “I don’t pretend to understand what’s going on between us right now.”

I smiled. “I’m not sure I do either.”

It was late. We turned out the lights and snuggled. She dozed off quickly, and I turned over and tried to make sense of my emotions. Even though I couldn’t point to a specific insight, it somehow felt like the pieces were coming together. There was a pattern with Terri. A subcurrent of animalistic passion that she tried hard to suppress because when she gave in, she could lose control, be self-destructive. And yet, it was a part of her, an exciting part of her, and it made me sad to realize that she felt, or had felt, the need to keep it hidden for so long.

CHAPTER 5:

IGNITION

“So do you ever hear from Chucky?” I tried to sound casual and failed miserably.

It was a couple of days after we had *the talk*. We’d just made love, and were lying in bed, her head resting on my chest. She didn’t answer.

“Terri? Are you asleep?”

She lifted herself off me and perched on an elbow, her breasts dangling sexily beneath her, looking at me now. I tried to read her expression. Was she angry?

“I’m sorry, I...”

She cut me off. “Why do you ask?”

“I dunno. It just... It just popped into my head.”

That same knowing smirk. “Oh really? Just now? You haven’t thought of asking me if I’m in touch Chucky even once these past two weeks?”

“No, I mean, maybe once in a while, it’s no big deal, I just wondered...”

She let me babble incoherently in that vein for a few more moments. Then she put a finger to my lips.

“Shhh, honey. Slow down.”

“It’s...”

“Shhh.”

When she was sure I was done, she took a deep breath.

“Are you angry that I told you those stories? Be honest.”

I had to think for a minute. “Maybe. Maybe a little.”

She nodded. “I’m sorry. I shouldn’t have done it. It’s just that when Janet threw it out at the party, I got a little angry too. I was drunk. I was feeling defensive. I felt like you were going to judge me. And I was, I guess, trying to shock you.”

I shook my head. “Terri, honey, I would never. The past is past. I mean, I can’t control my initial emotional reactions, but you have to know I would never hold something like that against you.”

“I know. Which is why I regret throwing it all out there... but that’s not what we’re talking about, it is?”

“I... I don’t know what you mean.”

She sighed.

“Okay, okay,” I relented.

“I can’t stop thinking about it. About you and him... them.”

“So what if I have been in touch with Chucky? Would it make you angry? Aroused? And what if I haven’t? Would you be relieved? Disappointed?”

“All of those,” I replied. “And maybe more. I don’t know why it has affected me so much, but it has.”

“Well, it has certainly spiced up our sex life,” she said with a grin.

“Did it need spicing?”

“I don’t know. You tell me. I think you have to admit that whatever has changed between us is mostly you, right?”

“Is it?”

“I think so. Seeing you so charged up definitely works for me too. You haven’t looked at me that way in years.”

“I’m sorry, I didn’t realize...”

She shook her head. “No, no, I don’t mean it that way. I mean, its just we’ve been together for a long time now. We have kids. You don’t have that same hunger for me, or least didn’t until recently. I mean, I wouldn’t expect you to. And it’s not just you. I mean, I haven’t seen myself that way either. I’ve been in mommy mode for a while. Wearing flannel PJs to bed, rather than this,” she said waving her hand over her nude body.

“So this is a good thing?” I asked a little uncertain.

“I don’t know. Why were you asking about being in touch with Chucky?”

“It... I don’t know.”

She regarded me skeptically.

“I really don’t.”

“This isn’t the first time you’ve thought about asking, though, is it?”

I didn’t answer. She could see my response in my eyes.

“So, how did you imagine the conversation going?” she prompted.

“I guess...I guess, when I’ve thought about it, I imagined you, like first blushing, like you’d been caught in something. And then slowly I pull it out of you. How you and Chucky, I dunno, maybe exchange Facebook messages sometimes, or maybe some flirty texts.”

“And that’s all? Just the occasional electronic communication?”

I nodded.

She stared at me doubtfully.

“Okay,” she continued slowly, “and how do you react? Do you get angry? Do you punish me? Does this turn into a spanking thing?” She grinned at me.

“No, nothing like that. It never...I’ve never played it out that far. You just admit it...and then I get jealous...”

“And aroused?”

I nodded.

“So if I admitted to you that I did sometimes still talk to Chucky, it would turn you on?”

“Do you?” I replied, jumping out of my metaphorical socks.

“Maybe,” she replied. “Facebook does make it so easy to keep in touch with people, doesn’t it?”

“Terri, are you just saying this to...?”

“Chucky was very disappointed when I stopped seeing him. He always reminds me that I can always come by for a visit.”

“So you *do* talk to him?”

She smiled slightly. “I mean, it’s all in good fun. Aren’t there any old girlfriends in your friends list? You don’t keep up with Melanie at all?”

“No,” I replied hoarsely.

She clucked sadly. “Oh, that’s too bad. It really is an ego boost. He loved those pictures you posted of us in Florida last year. We thought the kids looked so cute with that sand castle, but Chucky only seemed to notice that bikini I was wearing. You know, the white one?”

I swallowed hard. She’d looked so hot. It really was too skimpy. She’d worn a wrap most of the time, but I’d gotten this one unguarded picture of her laughing at the kids trying to defend their castle from the tide. I’d posted it on Facebook, with a caption about the kids, but I was showing her off as well.

“He said he’d like me to model it for him. And take it off for him.”

“Did he?”

She reached down and stroked my hard cock. She raised an eyebrow, and threw her leg over me. Without another word, she guided my prick to her pussy and firmly impaled herself on me.

“Uh huh,” she replied with a wicked grin.

She rode me enthusiastically. I crunched upward and kissed her breasts, and she adjusted herself so that as she rose and fell, her hard nipple trailed over my lips. I flicked my tongue against her nipple as she moaned softly.

I put my hands on her hips and urged her on, faster, harder. She threw her head back and climaxed with a lusty growl, and I immediately exploded into her still-pulsing pussy.

Sixty seconds, at most, from start to finish, but we were both slick with sweat and gasping.

As I caught my breath, my head cleared.

“So, you don’t really keep in touch with Chucky, do you?”

She looked up at me. “No....” She paused, smiled, her body hot against mine, hard and soft in all the right places. “No...but I could.”

“Chucky Doyle. Commercial architect. I’m pretty sure a Google search would give me all I need,” Terri said.

We’d showered, gotten into PJs, and were now back in bed together when I’d asked her how she’d get in touch with him.

“Would you? I mean, have you thought of it?”

She shook her head. “No, I couldn’t do that.”

“Why not? I mean, I don’t want you to. Not really. But what would be the big deal?”

“I told you, Chucky and I were never really, you know, friends. We didn’t really keep in touch when we were seeing each other. If I pinged him now, he’d think I just wanted to hook up again.”

“So? I mean, I don’t want you to hook up with him, but what’s wrong with a little flirting?”

“Bill, this is fun and all, but I’m not going to lead another guy on. That’s just not fair bringing another person into this if it is just a game between us.”

“What if it wasn’t a game? I mean, I don’t want you to, but what would you want?”

“*I mean, I mean, I mean, I mean...* listen to yourself, Bill. I don’t think I ever heard so much minimizing and distancing from you in ten years.”

“I’m sorry.”

She shook her head. "You want me to commit to hypotheticals, but you can't even come out and say what you're feeling."

"I know. It's...it's hard."

She shook her head. "Men are strange creatures. I know everyone says women are complicated, but you boys are so used to suppressing your emotions that you don't know how to deal with anything out of the ordinary."

I laughed. "Right, because women always respond calmly and analytically to emotional turmoil."

"Well, I think I'm the calm one here."

"Oh please, Terri. Stop putting this all on me. Yeah, I have something going on I can't quite figure, but it's not all me. You're enjoying this too much, and it's not just that you like seeing me turned on."

"Oh?"

"Yeah, you know you're getting a kick out of, I dunno, waving it in front of me."

"You're the one who keeps bringing it up."

"And you're the one who keeps answering in rich and explicit details."

She opened her mouth as if to reply. But then she hesitated. She looked at me pensively. "You're right."

"I am?"

She laughed and I joined her. "We're quite the kinky matched set, aren't we? I seem to like showing off, and you seem to like hearing about it."

"Emotional exhibitionist and voyeur," I suggested.

"Or sadist and masochist," she retorted.

"Okay, so..."

She put her hand up. "No, let's stop there. It's late." She pointed at the clock showing 2:39am. "The kids will be up soon, and anyway, we should probably sleep on it before we say anything more."

I nodded. She was right. We were dancing too close to emotional fires for comfort. I cuddled her close, and we both pretended to sleep, though it was pretty obvious we were both awake for a long time, trying to process the past few weeks, and working out the implications for the future.

Was I a voyeur? Worse, a masochist? That didn't feel right. I didn't like the pain, and I'd never spied on Terri, or anyone else. Sure, I liked looking at pretty girls. And like everyone else, I enjoy porn on occasion. But that's far cry from being a voyeur.

But there was a weird grain of truth to it. The white bikini, what was that all about? Why had I uploaded that picture, and why had I encouraged her to wear it even though I knew it was too much—or too little, whatever. And there was that night at O'Toole's.

Watching the Bears game. Terri in her Brian Urlacher jersey and painted on jeans. I'd gone to bathroom and inside were three young guys talking about the blond #54, describing what they wanted to do her in lurid detail. I remember thinking I probably should say something, defend her honor. Instead, I just tried to focus on pissing despite a growing erection. Sure it was a turn on. I mean, they were saying how hot my woman was. Just pride, right? Or had it turned me on to think about them taking her, using her like a dirty, submissive whore?

The idea of Terri cheating on me, having sex with another man, was devastating. It left a painful pit in my stomach to just think about it. And yet, I was somehow turned on by the notion that other men wanted to fuck her. And worse, I had to admit that when I thought of her and Chucky being in touch, the balance of pain and excitement was hard to disentangle.

If she spoke to him, would I be angry or aroused? And what if they did more than speak? I realized I was rubbing my crotch. I was hard again. At least that part of me knew the answer, or part of it.

I Googled "Chucky Doyle." She was right. He was easy to find. Handsome bastard. Work phone and email both easily accessible. Had she already known that when she said it? Of course she had, I thought. I rubbed myself harder, and before I knew it, I was coming hard, filling my shorts.

"We need to talk," I said as we climbed into bed.

She rolled her eyes. "I'm already naked, babe."

"I know, I know, but it's not that. Well. It is that, but I need to talk."

She laughed. "Jeez, when did you turn into the chick in this relationship?"

I shook my head. “No, don’t,” I replied. *Don’t call my masculinity into question*, I thought. “This is weird enough.”

She nodded, understanding.

“So, did you Google him?” she asked.

“How’d you...”

“Google auto completed it when I...”

“I was just curious, you know...” I stammered defensive. Then it struck me, “Wait, what were you searching?”

She gave me a knowing smile.

“Guilty,” she replied.

“So why were you looking him up?”

She shrugged her shoulders. “I don’t know. I swear I haven’t in years, but...”

“How many years?”

“Oh, I dunno, lots. At least since we’ve had the kids. But yeah, when we were first together, I did look him up once in a while. It was, I guess, like a safety blanket as we were getting more serious. Like knowing I had a port in a storm, or something.”

“More like a bed in the night.”

She smiled. “Okay. But are we talking about the last decade or last night right now?”

“Last night.”

“Okay, well, last night I’m going to have to blame you. You put the thought in my head by asking if I was still in touch. And I will remind you that you’d looked him up first.”

I realized my heart was pounding . I took a deep breath and tried to calm myself.

“So,” I began slowly, “so, last night both of us spent time on the computer trying to track down your old boyfriend.”

“Not really a boyfriend, but...”

“Right, your old lover.”

“I think the term we’d settled on was fuck buddy,” she replied with that same amused grin.

I shook my head to clear away the fog that was rapidly clouding my mind.

“And I presume we both found him?”

She nodded.

“So now what?” I asked.

“Now nothing,” she replied. “I told you, I’m not going to lead him on.”

“What are you saying? That if you ever ran into Chucky again you’d feel obliged to have sex with him?”

She gave me a quizzical look. “Running into him randomly is not the same thing as deliberately getting in touch.”

I was an autopilot, speaking before even processing what I was saying. “It could be. What if, you know, what if you just happened to be at a bar where he was for a happy hour or something?”

“Well, that would be random, wouldn’t it?” A look of understanding crossed her face. “Oh God, Bill, that’s crazy. What? We’d stake out his office and follow him somewhere?”

I hadn’t actually thought it through that clearly. But now that she’d said it, it seemed to make a lot of sense. I warmed to the idea quickly.

“Sure? Why not? Aren’t you curious what he’s up to? Whether he’s married? Has kids? Is still a player?”

“So, what? We’d follow him into a bar and just be all, like, *wow Chucky is that you, long time no see?*”

“Well, you would at least.”

“Oh, not the two of us?”

“Well, it just seems. I mean, you know, if I’m there, it’ll be all awkward.”

She laughed. “Oh right, because it won’t be awkward otherwise.”

“Well, less so at least. Just two old friends running into each other at random.”

“And then what?”

“I dunno. I really don’t. I mean, maybe you just say *hi* and go your own way, or maybe you have a drink and catch up.”

“So, let me get this perfectly straight. You want me, your wife, the mother of your children, to follow her old...” She paused. “Her old fuck-buddy into a bar and have a drink with him while he chats her up?”

“You wouldn’t be leading him on. And you wouldn’t need to do anything more.”

She grinned. “I dunno. I told you, Chucky can be very persuasive. I always did have a hard time saying no to him. What if he invites me up to his place?”

My heart was in my throat, but my cock was also throbbing almost painfully.

“You wouldn’t need to go. It would just be something for us. Just a little game. He doesn’t need to know. You wouldn’t be leading him on.”

“You’re crazy,” she replied. But all I noticed was that she hadn’t said no.

CHAPTER 6:

EXPECTATIONS

It was a harebrained scheme, and yet all the pieces came together seamlessly. His downtown office was close to the “L” and Terri noted that he used to live in Wrigleyville, so we assumed he either walked or took the train to work. All we need to do was stakeout the main entrance of his office.

We picked a Friday and arranged to have the kids spend the weekend with my folks. I picked up Terri early. She was dressed to impress, wearing that same clingy party dress from her birthday. If the plan to ambush Chucky failed, we agreed to go out to dinner instead.

We set up shop at Starbucks across from his office. Starting a little before five, his building started to empty out, and I was sure we’d never spot him in the crowd. But after just a few minutes, Terri gasped.

“Oh my God, there he is.” She pointed at a tall, slim, dark haired man exiting the building and heading north on La Salle.

“I’ll call if he goes somewhere close by,” I replied, dashing off after him.

It wasn’t a long chase. A block and a half away, he ducked into a bar with a large happy hour crowd. It was a trendy place. Lots of nice suits, girls who’d obviously “freshened up” before heading over. A meat market, but classy or at least expensive.

I texted Terri with the bar’s name.

Are you sure? she texted back. She was asking about the scheme, not the address.

It’ll be fun, I replied.

You’re crazy, she answered.

Chucky was at the bar, part of a small group of well-dressed men and women. Obviously a regular crew. They were laughing and trading shots. He seemed to be the elder statesman of the group, but definitely one of the guys.

I had managed to snag a small high top against the wall. I had a good view of the bar, although frequently interrupted as people crossed in front of me heading to and from the dining room.

I waited anxiously for Terri. I was about to text her, asking if she was backing out, but when I looked up from my phone I saw her. She approached Chucky and gave him an exaggerated reaction.

Oh my God, Chucky, is that you?

Terri, baby, let me buy you a drink.

I couldn't hear their conversation, of course, but that was the body language.

Chucky seemed to introduce her to his friends, but as I'd expected, dreaded, fantasized, he quickly pulled her aside and ensconced her on a bar stool as he hovered close over her.

I could feel the intimacy between them. At least I thought I could. At the very least, it was obvious they were comfortable with each other. They were huddled together. Was that just to be heard over the noise of the bar? She was smiling, laughing. Was that an act, just part of the game?

To me, though, they looked like an item, like lovers sharing some time together in public. As she laughed, she casually touched his forearm. He rested his hand easily on the back of her chair, his thumb caressing her back. She flicked the hair from her eyes. He bought another round of drinks and made a toast. She giggled at him. I could feel the jealousy coursing through my veins, and yet seeing her with him was undeniably erotic.

I looked closer. They were leaning in, talking softly. His hand... his hand was now on her bare thigh. Was she wearing underwear? Somehow I knew she wasn't. His fingertips were just inches from her naked pussy. Her hand was on his shoulder. Another drink. Another toast. She was glowing. He was looking at her, hungry.

A large group filtered past me, moving painfully slowly. They were leading an elderly couple, probably regretting having chosen a happy hour night spot for their early dinner with grandma and grandpa.

When they finally moved into the dining room, I looked back at the bar. The stools where Terri and Chucky had been were empty and quickly filled with other patrons. I couldn't see them.

And then it hit me like a shot. The bathroom. He'd offered. She'd accepted. She could never say no to him. She was bent over the sink right now, her dress rolled up over her ass. He was hammering her from behind.

I took a hurried step toward the restrooms. And then I saw them. They'd stepped back away from the bar. They had their phones out, exchanging numbers from the looks of it. He turned back toward his

friends. I caught Terri's eyes and nodded toward the door, asking if it was time to leave. She shook her head and glanced down at her phone. I pulled out my own phone just as her text arrived.

Go on ahead. He's going to walk me to a cab. Meet me at Mateo's.

That was one of our favorite places, a little tapas joint by our house. I started to text back, but noticed that she'd already put away her phone and was talking to him again. He nodded toward the door, and she started in that direction with him resting his hand on her shoulder as they fought through the crowd.

I hadn't planned ahead. I still had to settle my tab. By the time I did, they were long gone. I couldn't see them outside, though with the crowd and gathering dusk, that wasn't too surprising anyway. Still, it was hard to put out of my mind the image of the two of them leaving the bar together.

I got my car out of the garage and drove quickly to Mateo's, but I was easily fifteen minutes behind her. I expected to find her at the bar. But she wasn't there. I peered into the dining room. Not there either. I asked the hostess. No, they hadn't seen her.

I sat at the bar and ordered a shot, and sent her a text.

Hey babe, where are you?

Then I stared at the phone as if trying to will a response. One minute passed. Then five. I ordered another shot. Ten minutes. Fifteen.

Jesus. There was no other explanation, was there? She was obviously with him. Fucking him. Sucking his cock. Spreading her legs for him as he pounded her roughly. She was wearing her engagement ring and wedding band. He would know she was married. I imagined it turned him on, knowing he was having another man's woman.

Am I better than he is?

Oh yes, Chucky. Oh God yes. No one fucks me as good as you.

Her big tits jiggling. Her toes curled. Her stomach muscles rippling as he made her come again and again.

"Hey honey." She kissed me on the cheek and sat on the stool beside me. Her hand slipped into my lap, groping my erection. "Thinking of me?" she said with a grin.

"Where've you been?" I replied hoarsely.

She laughed. "I forgot my purse. I didn't have money for the cab."

"What'd you do?"

“What could I do? I had to blow the driver. You wouldn’t believe how much he came.”

I looked at her shocked. “You didn’t!” But the image was already in my mind. Both of them in the backseat, her dress pulled down to show off her tits, her red lips wrapped around his fat tool.

She laughed. “No, of course not. But I had to stop by the house to pick up my purse, then stop at the ATM to get some money. God, Bill, you really are losing it.”

“So that’s all?”

She nodded. “I could make up a story for you, but I’m afraid you’d ruin your suit, and anyway, I’d like to be able to move over to a table. I’m starved.”

We settled in at a little two-top in the corner of the room.

“So what happened with Chucky?” I asked after we’d ordered some small plates and a bottle of wine.

She shrugged. “Nothing that exciting. Just the usual catching up. How’re you doing? Still living on the North Side? That kind of stuff.”

“You seemed to be having a lot of fun for a conversation so banal.”

“Chucky was always a good talker. He’s funny. Lively. He talked about his job. Asked if I still saw some of the old gang. You know, that kind of stuff.”

“So, no flirting?”

“Oh, it was all flirting. But nothing really overt. He commented you were a lucky man. Said he missed me.”

“Did you flirt back?”

“Of course. Wasn’t that the idea? I asked why no woman had snatched him up yet. He reminded me I’d had my chance. Just silly stuff.”

We both sat silent for a moment.

“I saw him touch your thigh,” I said suddenly.

She laughed. “My, you were watching closely. Did you also see me move his hand away?”

“Not right away, you didn’t.”

She grinned. “No, I guess not. I gave him a few seconds. Did you see him rubbing my back?”

“Yes,” I replied, nodding.

“And did that make you jealous or excited?”

“Both,” I admitted.

“Should I have let him continue to rub my thigh?”

“Are you wearing panties?”

She laughed. “Would that make a difference? I am, but they’re really small. They wouldn’t have gotten in the way at all.”

I groaned.

“You didn’t answer. Should I have let him rub my thigh longer?”

“I dunno,” I replied finally, dully.

She nodded. “That...that answer says a lot.”

“Does it?”

“Well, yeah, I mean, I think most men would answer without hesitation.”

“Maybe.”

She shook her head. “No maybes about it. We’re no longer in realm of old war stories and fantasies. We’re talking about a real life, flesh and blood, man fondling your wife.”

“I know. I can’t explain it.” I paused for a moment. “And what about you? Did you want him to continue rubbing your thigh?”

“If I’d known you could see it, I might have let him have a little more time, given him a chance to explore past the hem of my dress.”

“How far?”

“I dunno,” she replied mirroring my earlier tone.

With perfect timing, her phone suddenly vibrated with an incoming text. She looked at it, shook her head and smiled.

“So now what?” she said, handing it to me.

I looked at the message. It was from Chucky. Short and direct.

Hey, Ter, it was great seeing you tonight. Sorry I had to run so soon. Love to catch up more. Drinks, maybe an early dinner next week?

“I thought you told him you were married,” I said.

She laughed again. “That’s not the sort of thing to deter Chucky.”

“Why an early dinner?”

She raised an eyebrow. “I dunno. Seems less threatening, maybe? Or maybe it hints at some post-dinner activities?”

I didn’t say anything.

She continued, “Why are you avoiding the issue? He just asked me out on a date. What do you think I should I say to him?”

“What do you want to say?”

She shook her head and clicked her tongue. “Naw uh, mister. You go first.”

“I can’t. I mean, it’s not like I’m the boss of you.”

“Oh, I’m not saying I’ll do what you suggest, one way or the other.”

“What’s that mean? If I told you to say no, you might still go out with him?”

She grinned. “No options are off the table.”

I chuckled. She was busting my chops. I knew she’d never go if I asked her not to, but she was playing it coy. Having fun. It encouraged me to keep going.

“So the question is: should I encourage my wife to go out on a date with another man?”

She held up her hand. “Remember what I told you. I’m not going to lead him on.”

“Does that mean you would sleep with him?”

“Well, not necessarily. He could blow it by being rude or obnoxious or something. But I don’t want to play games. We’re not naive. We’re not kids. We know what he’s thinking. And he knows I know. So saying yes means saying yes not just to the invitation, but to the expectations.”

“What if you’re wrong? What if his motives are pure?”

She laughed. “Very clever. A convenient out. We don’t really know what he wants, do we?”

I shook my head. “No we don’t.”

“Fair enough. I won’t go out of my way to seduce him. If he does just want to catch up, then we’ll just catch up and go our separate ways. But if he wants more and he’s a gentleman about it... well, let’s just say I won’t push his hand away when it’s sliding up my thigh.”

I looked at Terri. God, she was so beautiful, her face just glowing. She was amused. Definitely turned on by the conversation. As was I. The sexual tension was thick in the air. I didn’t want it to end. Didn’t want this feeling to fade.

I liked the idea of her flirting with Chucky, of the danger, the risk, the vitality this brought to our relationship. And surely she was overstating the expectations. Sometimes a dinner is just a dinner. Anyway, I didn’t think

she'd ultimately sleep with him. She liked the tension as much as I did, and her warnings were just a way to inject a frisson of excitement into the situation.

But what if they weren't? What if she meant what she said? What if he was his usual funny, charming self? And what if, after dinner, he invited her up to his place for a "nightcap?"

Images flooded my mind. Terri and Chucky walking unsteadily back toward his apartment, his hand resting comfortably in the small of her back. The two of them in an elevator, making out as he rubbed her breasts. In his stylish condo, Terri perched on the dining room table, Chucky standing between her spread legs, pulling down her dress, sucking on her tits. Terri nude, on her knees, eagerly slaving over his erect cock. The two of them in bed, her legs over his shoulders as he pounded her pussy mercilessly.

Terri interrupted my daydream. "I think you're drooling."

I wiped my mouth with the back of my hand. Not drooling, but definitely moisture in the corners of my mouth.

"So?" She tapped her phone, her lips curled in a suggestive smile. "What should I say to him?"

"I think you're exaggerating his expectations. I see nothing wrong with you have a meal with an old boyfriend."

"Fuck buddy," she corrected.

"Po-tay-toe po-tah-toe."

"And what if he does want more?"

"I trust your judgment."

"And what if I judge that I want to have sex with him? Not just because I think it'll turn you on, but also because I'll enjoy it?"

"I can live with that," I replied as calmly as I could, though my heart was pounding so hard it felt like it might burst from my chest.

"Really?"

"Really."

She shook her head and laughed. "You've gone crazy. You know that?"

"Maybe," I replied. "But all I know is that right now all I can think of is getting you home."

"Is that so?" She grinned lewdly.

"Yes," I said. When I stood, I had to hold my suit jacket in front of me to hide my full erection.

"Okay, but I need to do something first."

She unlocked her cell phone and began typing, reading aloud as she did.

“Chucky, yeah, definitely. Sounds like fun. 6:00 Friday? Tell me where.”

The next four hours were a blur. In the car, I reached over and ran my fingers up her thigh, over the same spot of skin Chucky had tickled just a few hours earlier. She didn’t push my hand away though, and I slid farther up her dress until I reached a point where her thighs turned hot and damp.

She was right, the panties didn’t get in the way. I slid a finger beneath the fabric, found her wet slit, rubbed her clit briskly. This was not a night for subtlety. She came hard, writhing in the passenger seat.

We got home. She dropped to her knees and pulled me close. But instead, I picked her up, kissed her hard, carried her up the stairs, her legs wrapped around my waist. I deposited her on the bed, pulled her legs apart, pushed aside her soaked panties and licked her pussy sloppily.

She gasped and thrashed, tried to push me away, but then came again, violently, bucking up and down.

“No more, no more,” she begged as I attacked her twat again.

She was so wet. Her pussy tasted like nectar. I sucked her clit into my mouth. It was hard, swollen. My tongue flicked at the hood. She was gasping, grunting, wheezing. She came again and went limp.

I wrenched down my pants, freed my hard cock, launched myself between her slick thighs. We were both fully dressed. I entered her, hard, but she was so wet it didn’t matter. We kissed wetly, sucking tongues as I humped her wildly—more like a horny teenager than a loving husband in his 30s. I lasted maybe 30 seconds until I came and collapsed onto her, both of us breathing hard, sweating, still kissing passionately.

We showered together. She sucked me hard. I took her from behind, pressed up against the tile, my hands mauling her tits, her head turned, kissing me sloppily over her shoulder. She came again, and fell to her knees, and stroked my cock roughly until I came on her tits.

Cleaned up, we stumbled into bed. We kissed. Long, slow, passionate kisses. Endlessly, our hands exploring each other’s bodies. When my erection finally returned, she pushed me onto my back and climbed aboard.

She rode me slowly, passionately, her hands on my stomach, mine on her breasts. Her eyes were closed, her head back. I crunched upward, sucked on her throat. She came hard and collapsed on me. I thrust upward, but I was too tired—too spent—to come. Instead, we fell asleep like that: naked, locked in a lovemaking embrace.

CHAPTER 7:

CULMINATION

I had set the alarm, so this time we were awake when my parents brought the kids home. We played at being normal, but each time Terri and I made eye contact, we burst into giggles.

That was the pattern for the week, at least until Wednesday when the reality of Terri's upcoming date began to loom larger.

I could sense her growing apprehension. It matched my own. Yet I was still in thrall to that wild cocktail of lust, jealousy, humiliation, and excitement that had defined my emotional life since Terri had made her first admissions about Chucky. And while she was increasingly anxious, she also seemed determined that I would need to be the one to pull the plug. I was too paralyzed by conflicting passions to do anything.

We didn't have sex Thursday, for the first time in a couple of weeks. Terri kept looking at me expectantly. But I never said anything.

Friday morning, I showered, dressed for work. Terri was giving the kids breakfast before taking them to school. I grabbed a banana and filled my thermos with coffee.

I kissed the kids. Gave Terri a chaste hug goodbye.

She seized my forearm, looked me in the eye.

"Remember, you have the kids this afternoon...and remember, I'll be home late."

I forced a smile. "Got it. Have fun."

She gave me an incredulous look. Then she shrugged and smiled. "Okay, I guess I will."

It's weird, but I didn't have much time to think about it during the day. Work was a series of crises. Once I picked up the kids, it was whirlwind of activity as well—games, dinner, reading, settling them down.

When I finally collapsed onto the sofa with a bottle of beer, it was 7:45pm. She'd been with him for almost two hours now, but they could easily still be at dinner. They probably were, actually, Terri enjoying the game, gathering up flirty exchanges with which to tease me later.

I pulled out my phone and prepared to send her a text, letting her off the hook, asking her to come home. I hesitated for moment, feeling my emotions churning as I considered the possibility of doing nothing, of letting things play out. Would she really have sex with him? It seemed unthinkable, sickening, and yet so hot. I laughed to myself. I *was* going crazy.

Just as I selected her name from my favorites list, my phone vibrated in my hands. A text from Terri.

On my way. There soon.

I was relieved. A little disappointed. But mostly relieved. And I was also turned on. My wife had been on a date with another man. They'd surely flirted. He'd probably rubbed her shoulders, her back. Had she let him slide his hand further up her thigh? Probably. I could feel myself getting hard. I decided to move to the bedroom, stripped to a bathrobe, to wait for her.

The wait seemed interminable, but it was less than fifteen minutes. I heard the door open downstairs. I heard her start up the stairs, check on the kids, and then she was in the bedroom.

In her stocking feet, she always looks so small, but for some reason tonight she seemed even more delicate. She was wearing a sexy wrap dress, but in a weird way, she looked like a little girl playing dress-up. I smiled at her. Her smile back seemed forced. Was she worried that she had disappointed me by ending the date early?

"It's okay baby, I'm glad you didn't..."

I saw the corners of her mouth drop. Then I noticed her hair, damp and lank. Had she been caught in some rain? Then I understood.

"You just showered." Part statement. Part question.

She nodded. "I wasn't sure you wanted to smell him on me."

"So, you did it?"

"Yes. I thought that was what you wanted," she said.

"Oh God."

She slapped her sides in frustration. "Fuck, I knew this was a bad idea."

She looked close to tears.

I was reeling. I felt sick to my stomach. I forced myself to breath, trying to keep my stomach under control. Her eyes watered up.

“It’s okay. Jeez, Terri, it’s okay. I did... It was my idea.”

She choked back a sob.

“Did you enjoy it?” I asked.

She hesitated.

“It’s okay. Tell me the truth.”

She still hesitated. Then a deep breath. Finally, she replied in a soft voice. “Yes.”

“Take off your clothes.” I didn’t even know why, but I needed to see her naked.

“Bill...”

“Please.”

She nodded. We were in weird, uncharted territory. It was obvious that she didn’t know how to react, and for my part, I was acting purely on impulse.

She reached down and untied the sash on her dress. She pulled it open and let it fall to the floor. She was naked beneath.

“Did you go out like that?” I gasped.

“Yes,” she replied a bit more confidently now.

Terri’s skin is so pale that it shows any mark. I realized now what I was looking for: physical signs that this wasn’t just a tale, a tease.

I reached out my hand and beckoned her toward me. It wasn’t obvious, but I could tell. Her breasts were a little blotchy, not bruised, but looked well handled, her nipples puffy and darker than normal. There were also streaks of red on her hips and thighs.

But my eyes were mostly drawn between her legs. She was shaved, as usual, and maybe it was a product of my over-active imagination, but her pussy seemed more prominent. Swollen, a darker red. As she approached me, I leaned in for a closer look.

She held out her hand. “Don’t kiss me there. It’d be too weird.”

“Did he finish inside you?”

She nodded. “Twice.” Then after a pause. “I cleaned myself, but...”

She didn’t need to complete the thought. He was still inside her. His jism, deep inside. Attacking her ovaries. Trying to impregnate her. A futile

mission since she was on birth control, but no less emotionally fraught for that.

I reached out with my hand and slid a finger between her labia, which split easily, exposing the swollen, pink flesh within. She felt slippery, velvety, tender. Her moan brought me out of my self-involved exploration of her anatomy.

I looked up her. "What happened? It's so early."

My reaction and the obvious look of lust on my face seemed to embolden her.

"We never made it to dinner."

She seemed to enjoy my incredulity.

She continued. "We were suppose to me at Flanagan's at six, but he was late. A little after six he texted me. He said he was running behind schedule. He invited me to his place for a drink while he got ready."

"And you went?"

"Well, it was just around the corner. And I was already getting annoyed at turning down drinks while waiting for him."

I nodded. The problem with looking like a Barbie Doll is that men are constantly hitting on Terri. I could see why she wouldn't want to sit in a bar waiting.

"I got there, and he gave me a glass of wine. Said he was going to take a shower."

I knew where this was going. Indeed, I already knew the outcome. And yet hearing Terri tell the story had me tied up in knots.

"He was gone for a few minutes. And then he came back out, wrapped in just a towel."

Her eyes seemed unfocused as she lost herself in the story.

"He's still in great shape," she offered.

I could picture him. Handsome guy. Slim. Well-defined muscles. Wrapped in a towel. Still dripping from the shower.

"How did you react?" I asked, dry mouthed.

"I didn't. I dunno, I was in shock I guess. Things were moving so fast."

I nodded and she continued. "He leaned down and kissed me. Just a small peck on the lips. And then he said, *this is what you're here for, right?* And I couldn't answer. I just nodded, I guess."

I groaned. She was saying so little, and yet so much. I filled in the details in my mind. His spacious, well-lit apartment. Terri on a stool before a marble topped counter. Her glass of white wine half-empty. Her lipstick marks on the rim.

“He leaned down and kissed me. More passionately this time. His tongue pressed into my mouth. I pushed him away. Kissing was somehow too intimate.”

I groaned again. I knew what was coming next. Kissing was too intimate. So instead...

“I pulled off his towel and stroked his cock. He got so hard, so fast, and I was like on autopilot. I leaned down and took him in my mouth.”

As she spoke, I continued to finger her pussy, feeling it getting wetter. Was that her? Him leaking out? I shuddered.

She laughed. “Are you okay?”

“I dunno,” I replied honestly.

She just watched me for a moment until I prompted her to continue, “So, you were sucking his cock...”

She grinned lewdly. “Mmmm. Yeah. And he had his hand in my hair, encouraging me to take him deeper.”

I grunted softly, shook my head. “I thought you were going to make him work for it. Instead, he gives you half a glass of wine and you’re blowing him.”

“I never said that I’d make him work for it. What I said was that he’d probably score if he was a gentleman.”

“Some gentleman. Late. No wooing. Just walks out in a towel.”

“Maybe, I’m easy.”

“With him you are.”

“You knew that when you sent me on a date with him.”

“Some date.”

But she knew she had me. I was still playing with her pussy, still obsessively running my eyes over her body, taking in every potential sign of their lovemaking, fucking, whatever.

“Do you want to hear the rest of what happened?”

There was a part of me that wanted to say no. Just pull the plug on the whole damn thing. Pretend it never happened. But that part of me never had a chance.

“Yes,” I groaned urgently. “Tell me.”

She smiled.

“We decided to get more comfortable. We went into the bedroom. I let him untie my dress. Unwrap me like a present. Then we settled on the bed. Like old times. I got on my knees, my head in his lap and took him back in my mouth. He explored my body with his hands.”

I was breathing heavily now. My own eyes becoming unfocused with excitement.

“He’s rougher than you are. Always was. He was squeezing my ass, giving me little spanks. Pulling my hair. But mostly he was playing with my boobs, grasping them firmly, pinching my nipples, stretching them out.”

“Doesn’t that hurt?”

“A little, I guess. The spanking, too. But it’s good as well. He follows it up with a gentle caress, you know, sort of pain then pleasure. And it’s the same with the sex. Very hard, very rough, until it’s almost too much, too intense, and I almost want to scream. And then he’ll stop, and as we’re both gasping for breath, he’ll go slow. Really slow. And it’s, well, soothing. And then it starts again.”

I felt sick. It sounded like he was better, much better than me in bed. Terri noticed my look and touched my cheek tenderly.

“It’s not better. Just different. Sex with you, I usually feel content, loved, cherished. With him I’m satisfied. Challenged. It almost feels like an accomplishment to take it, to keep up.”

“Did he make you come?”

She nodded. “Yes, the second time. Just once, though, in over an hour of actual sex. It took me a while to get comfortable. To get used to him again.”

“An hour?”

She nodded. “Yeah, which is why I’m a little sore right now. You and me, we’re more efficient, aren’t we?” she said with a smile.

I didn’t know how to take it.

“So, now that it has happened, does this all still turn you on?”

She pulled open my bathrobe and took my hard cock in her hand, stroking it firmly, just as she’d done for Chucky only a little while earlier.

She smiled. “I guess it does. What part of it is most exciting? Is it just the idea of me going to him? Is it the fact that I’m such a slut with him? So easy? Does it turn you on to think of him stripping me? Running his hands all over my body? Or are you thinking about him fucking me? Me on my

back, legs spread so wide, my hands pinned above my head by his strong grip as he pounds into me, over and over and over. Until I can barely catch my breath? Or are you picturing that moment, both of us sweaty, when he slows down and slides his prick inside me so slowly, so tenderly?"

"Oh fuck, all of it," I groaned miserably, hating my self for being so turned on by her fucking another man, and yet unable to deny the reality of my obsession.

"You can fuck me if you want. If you go slow," she offered gently...condescendingly?

I must have grimaced, because she quickly backed up. "I don't...I don't mean it that way. Like I'm giving you a gift."

"It's okay," I replied. But it didn't feel okay.

"I'm sorry."

"It's okay," I repeated. Then, "Tell me more. About him. About you and him."

"Are you sure?"

I nodded.

"He asked me about you. Asked if you knew."

"What did you say?"

"I told him you did. That it was sort of your idea."

I groaned. The humiliation was like a red hot poker to my side. But it was also weirdly exciting, an excitement she stoked effectively by squeezing hard on my cock as she pumped her fist up and down.

She grinned at my reaction. "He said he felt like that meant he had to do a good job."

A good job fucking my wife. I groaned again. "Did he?"

"Mmmm, yeah. I enjoyed myself."

"Would you do it again?" I said without calculation. The reality was that I was operating without any filter, without any plan. I was just saying the first thing that came to my mind.

"Do you want me to?"

"Would you?"

She smiled. "I would." Her voice was soft, throaty, and dripping with suggestion.

I realized, too late, how close I was. "Oh God," I groaned, coming hard in her hand.

It is hard to explain what went through my mind after that. I tend to be a pretty reflective guy. Lots of naval gazing, I guess. In some ways it would have been easier if I'd been one of those happy swingers, a vaguely dimwitted rube. Or maybe a free-love hippy. Or hell, a creepy, self-hating cuckold thriving on humiliation and pain. But I wasn't any of those...

I'd always been a pretty conservative guy, sexually if not always politically. Too much so, in retrospect. College would have been more fun if I'd been less squeamish, less self-righteous, more generally adventurous. I'd had my flings, but I'd left a lot on the table.

Obviously Terri had seen that in me. I was a "nice guy," the kind who would respond to a long, drawn-out courtship not with frustration, but with deepening respect and affection.

I guess that was one thing I was having trouble with. She'd played me. Manipulated me when we'd first met. But so what? Don't we all? I let her believe that I was a Sarah McLachlan fan, a nature lover who liked hiking forest trails, when really I would have preferred to go to a Metallica concert and watch football on TV on a glorious Fall afternoon. So we both put on a mask at first. Who doesn't?

But I couldn't shake the feeling that I was still being setup somehow. That Terri had caused all of this... this weirdness to happen. But that didn't make sense. What? She'd conspired with Janet to bring it up? Known I would raise it again? Trusted to her raw sexuality to elicit a response out of me? Jeez, it was crazy. And even if she'd played me that first evening, I had to admit, I was driving the train ever since. Or was at least an active co-pilot.

I pushed for the crazy scheme of stalking him. I was the one who'd pushed for the "date." Somehow the fact that he hadn't even bothered to meet her at the bar, that he'd just invited her to his place, that she'd gone and fucked him, was incredibly hurtful...and undeniably hot. The moreso for being unexpected. Jesus, just weeks ago, my main impression of her was of a mother, a homemaker, a sweet girl more comfortable baking cookies and playing board games than anything else. But she was so much more.

I winced... even that digression reflected my conflicting emotions. Here I was trying to explore and make sense of my feelings, only to be

almost immediately diverted to the image of Terri, my wife, so eagerly tugging at his towel, taking his hard cock into her mouth.

Why was it such a turn on? In a weird way, it was an ego boost. My wife was a sexy bitch. Somehow all of this seemed to reinforce that realization. And she was mine. But why did I need to share her to appreciate that? And then it occurred to me that maybe what I was really responding to was seeing this other side of her. I'd always known she was sexy, intellectually at least. She's pretty. She turns me on. I enjoy sex with her. But with me that's always been, I dunno, a perk, a fringe benefit rather than the essence of her.

But suddenly she wasn't just that, she was something more. With Chucky, she was raw, unfettered. With him, she was a pure sexual being. She wasn't my wife. She wasn't the mother of my children. She wasn't a friend. She wasn't a homemaker. She was just a hot slut who loved to fuck. With him, she could be a whole different person, and something about that was insanely hot. I couldn't explain it, but there it was.

Chucky was exposing it to me for the first time. I was seeing the raw sensuality beneath the surface. And it was that more than anything else that got me going. This sense of discovery, of realization that the woman I'd been sharing my bed with—with whom I'd built a comfortable home and life—that she had within her a whole other side.

CHAPTER 8:

EXTENSIONS

We were banging like teenagers. The littlest things would get me going. When she came out of the shower, I'd remember her coming home from him, freshly showered. When she changed, I'd think of him *unwrapping* her. A glass of wine would remind me of his easy seduction of her.

But most of all was her phone. He'd sent her flirty a text immediately after, under the guise of making sure she'd gotten home safely. She'd replied hours later, saying she'd had fun. He wrote back that he'd like to see her again. She replied with a non-committal, but suggestive emoticon: ;-)

He knew enough to step back for now.

But that phone was their link, and every time it rang, or buzzed with a text, every time she read her email, or checked the weather, every time that phone was in her hands, I thought of him contacting her, arranging another assignation. I knew her passcode, but I never breached her privacy, even as the days passed, and I increasingly suspected they were talking, texting, whatever.

And then the following Wednesday, we'd put the kids to bed and were sharing a glass of wine on the patio. She was in a cute flowered little sundress, her hair loose and flowing over her shoulders, wearing a matching scrunchy as a bracelet.

Her phone buzzed. She glanced at the incoming text and gave me a grin. She passed it over.

It was a message from Chucky. *Hey baby, whatcha up 2?*

I shrugged. It didn't seem like much. "So?"

She laughed. "He's booty calling."

"Huh?"

"Watch," she replied.

She texted to him, *Not much, just hanging around.*

Her phone buzzed back instantly with his reply, *Yeah, me too, wanna come over?*

I'd never been part of the booty call culture. I couldn't recognize it when it happened. I was getting window onto a whole new world.

Terri was looking at me, phone in hand, obviously waiting for my reaction.

"What?" I asked. "I mean, do you want to go over?"

"I could," she replied with a grin. "Or I could stay here with you. Or, I could go and then come back to be with you. What do you want?" She put a strong stress on the *you*.

I sighed. I wanted her to go. I wanted to experience that exquisite combination of lust and jealousy that would result. I wanted to think of her being taken hard by Chucky, enjoying a sexual experience different than what I provided, and one that she obviously craved even if she wouldn't quite admit it.

I wanted her to go, but I didn't want to have to say it out loud. I wished she'd take the responsibility herself. That she'd simply assert her desire to be with him. But I realized she was probably right not to do so. She wanted this too, but she wanted me to be complicit, not because she was trying to humiliate me—although I imagined she got a small thrill out of that—but rather because that way I could never, in a moment of jealousy, throw it back in her face.

I took a middle ground.

"What would you do if you went?" I asked.

She smiled and leaned forward, giving me a shot of cleavage. Then she rose and sauntered over to me, her hips swaying sultrily. She stood over me. For a moment, I thought she was about to climb into my lap or bend down and kiss me. But instead she squatted down in front of me, knees spread wide, her dress riding up to expose her creamy thighs.

She rubbed my thighs and slid her hands into my crotch, rubbing my rapidly forming erection through my pants. Without hesitation she reached for my zipper and pulled it down.

I looked back over my shoulder into the house. "What about the kids?" I asked.

She didn't miss a beat, "You have kids now, Chucky?"

I groaned, but didn't have time to reply before she began to insistently pull at my waistband. I lifted myself off the chair and she firmly pulled down my slacks and boxers. I settled back in the seat, my cock standing at attention in my lap.

She gave me a saucy smirk. She pulled off her scrunchy and piled her hair into a loose bun. I groaned again. There was something so feminine about that gesture, but also so practical, so lewd, so experienced about it that just set me off.

But again, she didn't give me time to contemplate it. Instead, she gracefully leaned forward and swallowed my hard cock deep into her mouth and immediately started bobbing up and down. Leaning forward was the last graceful thing she did, though, because her blowjob was raunchy, wet, sloppy.

She alternated between deep, slobbery swallows and roughly jerking me with her fist, her palm twisting over my cockhead on each stroke. It was a whore's hummer, aggressive, designed to make a john blow quickly. It was, I realized, how she serviced Chucky.

"Oh God," I sighed.

She hummed contentedly around my prick, the vibrations delicious against my shaft. Then she looked up at me, her lips encircling my cock, her blue eyes meeting mine.

She let me slip from her mouth and now stroked me more gently, breaking character. "Do you like the idea of me doing this to him?"

"Yes," I heard myself reply before my brain was even done processing the question.

She didn't answer. Instead, she took me completely into her mouth and resumed her dirty slob job. I began thrusting upward. After a few moments, she took just my cockhead in her mouth and swirled her tongue around the glans, all the while pumping my shaft with her fist. I wanted it to go on forever, but I couldn't help myself. I came with a violent shudder, filling her mouth with my seed. She gulped it down and continued stroking me until she'd milked me dry.

"God, that was amazing," I moaned as she stood up.

"So, I guess I should get going," she said simply.

I nodded. I couldn't think of anything to say.

She nodded as well. Then as I watched in shock, she reached under her dress and pulled off her panties. She held them out in front of me.

"I won't be needing these," she said as she dropped them in my lap.

She grinned at my open-mouthed look of surprise. Then when I didn't say anything, she turned and with a sexy swivel in her hips walked to the front door. She grabbed the car keys and was gone.

There was no ambiguity about it this time, no possibility of denial about what was happening. She wasn't flirting. She wasn't teasing. His apartment was less than fifteen minutes away, and once that quarter hour elapsed, I knew they were having sex. She'd even helpfully demonstrated to me how she intended to begin it.

I wasn't hard, but my cock felt oddly sensitive, any stimulus—from the fabric of my boxers to my hand brushing my crotch—was enough to give me shivers. I had her panties in my hand, fingering them, squeezing them into a ball. Twice I put them down, only to pick them back up obsessively moments later.

I was in the bedroom, frantically flipping through TV channels. I couldn't focus on anything, not TV, but also not even my feelings about Terri being with another man...again. It was like a bout of ADD on steroids.

And then she was back. I heard the door open. It had been 112 minutes since she'd left. Fifteen minutes each way. They'd had 82 minutes together. Had they fucked twice, or three times? More?

She came right up and closed the bedroom door behind her. Her dress seemed even more flimsy than before—just a sheer sheet of fabric covering her naked body. She was grinning, face flushed, hair roughly combed, by her fingers from the look of it.

“Did you have fun?” I couldn't keep a sneer out of my voice.

She smirked. “Mmmm, yes. It was less awkward. More like old times.”

“So he made you come more than once?”

She nodded and approached me, a little spring in her step. She stood beside the bed and lifted her dress above her head, exposing her naked body. Her alabaster skin showed the marks of his rough handling, and she twisted this way and that as if showing off to me, letting me see the redness on her ass, the puffiness of her nipples, and what seemed to be a bite mark on her belly.

“Am I going to need to wash those in extra hot?” she said, glancing at her panties, balled up in my hand.

“What? I...” Then I realized what she meant. She wanted to know if I’d jerked off into them while she was away. “No, I was waiting for you.”

She crawled up onto the bed and reached into my lap. “Mmmm, I can see that,” she cooed.

She rolled onto her back and pulled me on top of her. “I don’t need any foreplay,” she said matter-of-factly. “I’m still wet from him.”

“You’re a whore,” I growled. I didn’t mean it. It just came out.

“No,” she replied, reaching between us and pulling my cock from my boxer. “A whore washes up between tricks.”

I plunged inside her. She was soaked, her pussy loose, puffy, and very hot.

“Sloppy seconds...well, technically, thirds since he came inside me twice.”

I grunted and fucked her harder, the lack of friction being the only thing that kept me from coming right away.

“Tell me,” I ordered.

“He was extra eager, fervent even. He barely let me get inside his apartment. He spun me around and shoved me against his heavy door. He lifted up my dress and went down on me from behind.” She moaned softly. “Oh God, baby, you’re fucking me so hard, I can barely think.”

She was right. I was almost frantic. I slowed down a little.

“Mmmm, that’s better,” she sighed. “Where was I?”

“He was eating you out from behind.”

She smiled. “Hanging on every word, eh?” But before I could answer, she continued, “Mmmm, yeah. He’s a dirty boy. He licked me all over. All over.”

“Oh God,” I groaned as the image hit me. Had she reached behind, spreading her cheeks so he could more easily tongue her rosebud? I’d never done that for her, never imagined she’d like it, but also never really been tempted either.

“Do you like that, um, sort of thing?” I asked a little defensively.

“It was hot,” she admitted.

“And did it stop with that?”

She shook her head. “Ummm, no. He stood up and took me from behind.”

“You mean?” Had she given him her butt?

“No, not that. Not yet.”

“Yet?”

“Wait,” she replied. “You’re getting ahead of things.”

“Okay, okay, just tell me what happened,” I gasped.

“We had sex. He was behind me. Thrusting hard. Almost lifting me off the ground.”

I was thrusting harder now as well, her pussy so wet with her excitement and his come that it squished with each stroke.

“He was playing with my butt. Squeezing it hard. Spanking me. He slid his thumb between my cheeks and...” She paused. “I can’t think when you’re going that hard.”

I was again hammering her frenziedly. I forced myself to breathe and slowed down again, trying to focus on the feel of her pussy, velvety and wet.

“Mmmm, that’s nice.”

I slowly stroked my cock into her sloppy pussy. Anyone watching us would see nothing out of the ordinary. Just a man and his wife making love conventionally, a boring missionary screw. But my mind was reeling, not just from what she’d already told me, but from what I imagined was coming next.

She’d started talking again, and I picked it up mid sentence. “...I asked him not to, but I guess I wasn’t that convincing...”

“What? What did he do?” I groaned.

“His thumb...in my butt.”

“Oh God,” I gasped. “Was that your first time?”

She nodded. “Hmmm, yeah. He’s always been more into that sort of thing than you. Tickling me back there. Maybe a little finger tip once in a while, but nothing like this.”

“Did you like it?”

“I... I... I don’t know. It didn’t feel that good. You know, uncomfortable, distracting. But I liked the way it made me feel.”

“What?”

“Dirty, slutty. And it was like Chucky could read my mind. He leaned in close, breathing right into my ear, calling me a filthy whore, taunting me about how much I loved his fat thumb in my ass while he slammed me into the door over and over.”

I was hammering into her roughly again, but now Terri seemed to welcome it. She was gasping and grunting.

“Oh yeah, just like that,” she cried. “He called me a slut. Then he said his thumb was just the beginning. That he was going to fuck me in the ass. Oh, God, baby, it was so dirty, so nasty. I... I.... ahhhhh,” she came hard on my cock, demonstrating for me her reaction to Chucky’s taunts.

“Did he?”

“Huh?” She looked at me through dreamy eyes.

“Oh God, Terri, did you...did he...Christ, did he fuck you in the ass?”

“No,” she replied with a grin. “No, I told him I’d have to ask your permission.”

“What?!”

“I told him he couldn’t have anal sex with me unless you agreed to it,” she paused.

I couldn’t speak. Couldn’t move.

“Well? Is it okay with you if Chucky fucks me in the ass?”

“Oh God,” I groaned as I exploded inside her.

We lay side by side panting for a few minutes, and then she rolled over to face me.

“Well, mister, you didn’t answer my question.”

“Are you serious?”

She nodded. “He said that was the one thing he regretted not doing with me.”

“Jeez, Terri, is this something you want to do?”

She nodded quickly, blushing and looking away. “The idea has always sort of turned me on. But I guess I was always scared, maybe embarrassed.”

“But you’re not scared anymore?”

“No, I still am. But less so. Or maybe I’m getting braver.” She paused. “Would you want to try it?”

The idea turned me on immensely. Probably my most popular search when looking for porn online was “anal” or “teen anal” or “rough anal.” Something about seeing a young porn star, dressed up as a schoolgirl and getting pounded in the butt always got me going. The juxtaposition of innocence and raunch. But even as that went through my mind, my body was already reacting negatively, slowly shaking my head.

It was precisely that it was so raunchy, so dirty, that I was at once turned on and freaked out. And while I liked the idea in theory, I knew I could never follow through—never do with Terri.

But she wasn't really asking me anyway, I knew. She was probably just saying it by way of reassurance. But she also wasn't just teasing me. I could tell from the way she was looking past me, biting her lip, clearly anxious. The situation with Chucky had triggered something in her. She might say this was about me and my obsessions, but it was obvious that she was also exploring her own fantasies.

I didn't answer. And she didn't push it. But the question hung out there between us. Were there any limits on what I would let her do with Chucky?

Fundraising for school projects has to be one of the most thankless tasks imaginable. Terri's "class mom" duties involved putting together an auction for the annual fund drive. Worse, after finagling a pair of tickets to a new modern art exhibition for the auction, there were no bidders, so we ended up "winning" them ourselves.

Now, my interest in modern art—well any art really—is pretty limited. Terri's is barely higher. But the gallery owner who had donated the tickets seemed eager to meet with the winning bidders, so we didn't have any choice but to get dressed up and attend.

Even though neither of us were interested in the art, it had the potential for a fun evening. Art gallery openings draw out an eclectic crowd, always good for people watching, and there was an open bar. No dancing, just a jazz trio for background, but even still an opportunity to dress up.

I went plain, all in black: suit, shirt, tie. Terri added the color, sporting a floor-length, clingy, green satin dress that left very little to the imagination. Very little. Amazing how sexy it is possible to be without showing any skin.

The gallery owner quickly ascertained that we were not candidates for a big purchase, and since he was flaming, even Terri's charms did little to encourage further conversation. After being dismissed, we wandered the gallery aimlessly, snarking at the exhibits, commenting on the more gaudily attired guests.

It was a genteel crowd, but it was obvious as we walked around that Terri was getting as much attention as many of the pieces on display—at least from the men in the room.

I leaned in close. “Seems like that dress of yours has a lot of admirers.”

She laughed. “Don’t be silly. Everyone is dressed up.”

“Then it must be what’s underneath. Because I don’t think there is a man here who isn’t thinking about banging you.”

“*Banging?*” She giggled. “Do you mean they want to *do me*? Am I *hittable*?”

“Not only that, but I’m sure they’d love to *bone* you, maybe even give you a *hot beef injection*.”

She laughed louder. “Stop, Bill, please. You’re getting me so hot with your dirty talk.”

“Wait. You didn’t let me give the best one. I bet there are even some guys here who’d like to *pork you*.”

“Count me in,” she replied, then leaning in close she gave me two quick pig snorks.

I laughed and tapped her empty glass. “Do you want another, or should we get out of here?”

“I think we should milk the open bar a little longer. Might as well get our money’s worth.”

“If we do that, they’ll have to carry us out of here.”

“That could be fun. Depends on who’s doing the carrying.”

I shook my head. “You’re wild.”

She laughed. “Don’t blame me. You’re the one who got me all worked up with your talk of banging and porking. How’s an innocent girl like me supposed to resist that kind of talk?”

I laughed. “Oh yes, so innocent. Next time I’ll make sure we have a fainting couch nearby in case you’re overcome by the vapors.”

She batted her eyelashes at me.

“Okay, I’ll be right back.”

I took her glass and edged my way up to the bar. It seemed as if many of the guests shared my view of the exhibition. The bar was the most crowded area of the gallery, and with various hipsters ordering 1950s cocktails, it took a while to get two glasses of wine for me and Terri.

Not surprisingly, when I finally returned, Terri was locked in conversation with another man. He'd apparently arrived bearing gifts because she held a half-full wine glass in her hand and was sipping it slowly as he spoke, gesturing periodically at the installation before them: an unstable-looking tower of wire-mesh encircling a length of newsprint twisted into a double-helix. Something about freedom of the press?

I wondered if he was the artist, but he didn't have that kind of look. He was older. Mid-50s probably. A full head of white hair, but tall, well-built. His hands were large and he moved them with a forceful precision. A surgeon maybe. A CEO. A man used to respect, to commanding a room. Did he remind her of Gary?

I wouldn't say Terri was rapt, but she was certainly attentive to him. She laughed at his jokes. Leaned in closer when he lowered his voice. Was lively in response to whatever he was asking her. And, I couldn't help but notice, even though I'd been away longer than expected, she wasn't looking for me.

Ever since she'd hooked up with Chucky, I'd fantasized about her with other men. I couldn't help it. But those fantasies were always abstract. It was a generic other man. A policeman, a plumber, some executive in a suit, not another flesh-and-blood human being. Until now.

He was older, but powerful. I imagined him escorting her through the gallery, impressing her with his knowledge, his presence. He'd lead into the side room, less populated, quieter. Talking softer, he'd draw her in, closer. A hand on her forearm to call her attention to a particular painting.

She'd feel the attraction. Feel her own desire. I would duck out of sight as she looked over her shoulder guiltily, worried that she was betraying me, not realizing how turned on I was. Then he'd cup her chin in his hand, kiss her gently. She would feel the lust, the passion boiling up inside her. He would feel it as well, kissing her harder now, his strong hand cupping her breast, his thumb teasing her nipple as it stiffened and pressed through the fabric of the dress.

She'd be his for the taking, but he would be too classy to finger her in public or bend her over a bathroom sink. Instead he'd take her hand and lead her outside. She'd look around for me, grateful that I wasn't there to stop her. Then to his car—an expensive sedan, a Jaguar maybe, with black leather and walnut trim. She'd be nervous. Worried about how I'd react

when I found out. But he'd be calm, in control, the right mix of funny and flirty to keep her in the mood and comfortable.

Then to his home, an expensive, tastefully appointed Lincoln Park brownstone. Once inside, he would let the facade fall. He would kiss her hard, his hand firmly gripping her hair. Then he would order her to strip, save for her heels and jewels. With him still fully dressed, he would lead her upstairs to the bedroom—

“Bill? Where've you been?”

I shook my head to clear my thoughts. “I didn't want to interrupt. Looked like you were making a friend.”

She rolled her eyes. “What do you expect? You left me alone forever.”

“No, I mean, he was a good looking guy, don't you think?”

“Are you going gay?” she said with a grin.

“No, I...”

She laughed. “I know what you mean, husband. You were thinking that since I'm—we're, um, exploring my inner,” she leaned in close, “slut, that maybe I'd just let myself get picked up by some random stranger.”

“Well, I don't know. I mean, I know he's not *Chucky*, but why not?”

She shook her head. “Bill, I don't know how this works, or how you think this should work. Is that where we are now? You just choose random guys and I have sex with them?”

“No, God, I'm not saying that. Why would you say that?”

“It just seems—”

“No, Terri. Look, all I was asking was whether you'd considered it. A handsome, older, successful man comes onto you at a party. After the last few weeks, don't you think about it?”

“I... I... Wow, that's a tough one.”

“How so?”

“Well, okay, so did I notice he was handsome? Yeah, of course. Did I know he was coming onto me? Sure. But I don't know. That's as far as it went in my mind. I was here with you. I just wasn't thinking about it.”

“What if we'd run into Chucky? Would you have thought about it then?”

“But that's not the same thing,” she exclaimed. She hadn't actually answered the question. She didn't need to. Of course she would have. “Chucky and I were lovers. It is inherently a different relationship.”

There was nothing about what she was saying that was particularly controversial, but it still bothered me somehow. I couldn't put my thoughts into words. What did I want? Would it really have been better if Terri was thinking lewd thoughts about other men? About co-workers and random strangers and handsome, mature men she met at parties? The thought sent another twinge of excitement through me. What the fuck was wrong with me?

Then suddenly she turned and headed for the door. I caught up to her in the parking lot, but we didn't talk. Not a word through the entire ride home.

CHAPTER 9:

COMPLICATIONS

We finally climbed into bed together and she turned toward me. She had a weird look on her face, as if she were balanced between competing emotions. “This is fucking insane.”

I looked at her in surprise, almost as if I were seeing her for the first time. We’d been gradually stripping away layers over the past few weeks, both of us exposing more of ourselves than we ever had.

“Tell me what’s going on,” I said by way of a reply.

She laughed, but there were suddenly tears in her eyes. “I don’t know, honey, but I don’t want to lose you.”

“Never.”

She forced a smile and wiped her eyes. “Easy to say. But I’m afraid you won’t like the real me.”

“And what’s that?”

Her eyes glistened again, and a single tear ran down her cheek. “A whore. A slut.”

“No, don’t say that! That’s just... That’s just part of the game. Just words.”

She shook her head. “No, Bill, it’s more than that. I like it. I like the way it makes me feel to go to Chucky, knowing it’s about nothing more than sex. Driving to his place, with no panties, knowing that there will be no romance, no talking, just fucking. God, it makes me feel so alive.”

I smiled. “I know. That’s part of what has me so turned on. Seeing this other side of you.” I paused, hesitated, before continuing. “And I also know it’s not something I can provide. It can’t just be sex between us. There’s just too much else.”

“That doesn’t mean I have to do it.”

“No, but why not? It turns you on. It turns me on.”

Even as I said it, I could feel my stomach churning. Here I was, again, talking my wife into having sex with another man—and not just sex, but dirty, animalistic fucking.

“So what are the boundaries?”

“I trust you,” I replied.

“Really?”

“Really.”

She scooted closer to me, her hand trailing over my stomach, cupping my package.

“So, if he wants anal sex, I should let him?”

My cock reacted immediately, twitching to life. She stroked my increasingly turgid shaft.

“If that’s what you want.”

“I do,” she cooed. “I want him in my butt.”

I groaned softly.

“What if he wants to take me out, play with me in public?”

That one sent a shiver up my spine. I pictured him stroking her thigh at the bar. Imagined him fingering her at the club. Fantasized her bent over a bathroom sink.

“I trust you,” I choked out.

She stroked me harder.

“What if he wants to—”

“Oh God, anything. Anything you want.”

“Anything?” Her voice dripped with suggestion.

“Anything,” I groaned, suddenly realizing how close I was.

Terri realized it too, and without hesitation dove below the covers. Her mouth found my cock just as I started to come.

It was another week before they hooked up again. Another week of daily bouts of anxiety and anticipation followed by amorous romps in bed. But sure enough, he’d sent a text and she’d accepted and gone.

Less than 30 minutes later my phone rang. It was Terri. She couldn’t be done yet, and anyway, she usually just texted that she was coming home rather than call. Something must be wrong. Maybe they’d fought. Maybe her car had broken down.

I answered the call.

“Hey, what’s up?” I asked.

Nothing. No answer. Just some rustling. Some background noise. Then I heard sounds, labored breaths, groans. Had she been in an accident?

“Terri? Is that you? Is everything okay?”

More grunts and whines.

“Terri? What’s wrong?”

Then suddenly, her voice, strained: “Oh God, Bill, oh God, he’s in my ass.”

“Are you okay?”

“It hurts,” she groaned.

“You don’t have to—”

His voice cut me off. Distant, muffled, he said, “Tell him.”

“It hurts,” she groaned again, “but I like it. I like it.”

A small chuckle, then “Good girl.”

“Terri? Terri, are you sure? You can stop.” I gasped into the phone, but there was no reply. The line had been disconnected.

I immediately called back, but it went right to voice mail. Her phone had been turned off.

I could picture it. Couldn’t help but picture it, in fact. Terri on her hands and knees. Chucky behind her ramming his fat cock into her ass. Even though she’d told me we were the same size, in my mind’s eye, he was huge. He would have planned it. Taken her phone from her purse before taking her to bed. And then, when he was inside her, as she struggled to adjust to the new sensation, he’d called my number and placed the phone by her mouth so that I could hear her sounds.

You bastard, she’d probably said after he hung up, but with a smile.

But he probably had the bigger smile because even as I was thinking all this through, I knew he was still inside her ass, sodomizing my eager wife.

She didn’t come back home for almost another two hours. I heard her car pull into the driveway, but when she didn’t come inside for a few minutes, I went downstairs to see what was going on.

She walked into the house just as I was coming down the stairs. She looked like death, pale faced, walking gingerly, eyes unfocused.

“Oh God, Terri, are you okay? Did he hurt you?”

She looked up at me with blank eyes, slowly processing my words. Then she shook her head slightly and resumed her careful shuffle over to the sofa.

“Terri, do you need to see a doctor?”

She dropped onto the cushions.

“No, I’m...I’m okay,” she replied shakily. “Just...could you get me a drink?”

“Wine?”

“Scotch.”

She rarely drank anything hard. Still, I nodded and gave her a generous pour. She took a big gulp. Then she looked at me again, a wan smile on her face.

“That was...intense.”

“What happened?”

“Honey, I’ll tell you everything, but I’m not sure I’ll be able to, um, entertain you after. Would you rather I tell you later?”

“No,” I replied quickly. “Tell me now.”

She nodded. “I’ve never... It’s weird... I didn’t expect...”

“Terri, slow down. Just tell me what happened.”

“Well, you know what happened. I gave...he took my butt. I thought it would be just a quick thing, you know, just, like when he put his finger back there. A little weird, but you know, not that big a deal.”

“But it wasn’t?”

She shook her head. “God, I don’t even know how to explain it. When he first put it in, it took my breath away.”

“It hurt?”

She nodded again. “Yes, but that wasn’t the main sensation. It was more this sense of being taken, of being completely possessed. The feeling was so intense, so overwhelming. Then he’d pull out, almost all the way, and I could breathe again. Think again. And then he’d enter me, and I wanted to scream, but I couldn’t even make a sound. Maybe it was just because it was my first time. He didn’t harm me. I’m not, you know, injured or anything. Just shaken up.”

“How did he treat you after?”

“There wasn’t much *after* to speak of. He, um, dragged it out. He’d do it for ten, fifteen minutes, then we’d take a break, he’d caress my back, rub my shoulders, the whole time saying how good it felt, how much he was enjoying fucking my ass. Then we’d switch positions and start again.

“We started off side by side, him spooning me as he entered me from behind. Then he put me on my hands and knees and took me that way. Then

he laid on his back and pulled me on my back on top of him. God that was intense. Him thrusting into my butt, my entire body available to his hands.”

“Did you come?”

“Yes, twice. The first was before the anal, when he was just sort of playing with me. But then, yes, once, during. When I was laying across him. He was deep inside me, and then he stopped thrusting and just rubbed my clit.”

She had a distant look in her eyes as she relived the moment. The realization that she was still with him at that moment, even though she was physically with me, was like a kick in the gut.

She noticed. “Are you okay with this?”

“I don’t know,” I admitted honestly.

“You know I love only you.”

“But you love what he does to you.”

She hesitated. “I don’t know. I guess I do.”

“Why?”

“Oh God, Bill. What do you want from me?”

“I want you to be happy. It makes me happy.”

“Does it? Does it really?”

“I think so.”

“Think? Jesus, Bill, I need more certainty. I can’t have you come back and hate me for this, resent me, throw it back in my face.”

“Terri, this is new to me. I wish I had certainty, too. All I know is that all of this turns me on....” I paused. Hesitated. This was the hard part. “And hurts. Fuck, it hurts. Goddamn it, Terri, I wish all you wanted was me.”

She had tears in her eyes. “Bill, all I need is you. I swear.”

“I know. I know. I’m all you need. I get it. But I’m not all you want.”

“You could be.”

I shook my head. “No, baby, I couldn’t. I could never do to you what he did tonight. You know that.”

“He didn’t do anything to me. Nothing I didn’t want.”

I sighed. I knew that. Why was it so hard to explain myself? The reality was, I knew, at least in part, what she wanted, craved, if not needed. She got off on that feeling of being taken. Her parents seemed like decent folks, so it wasn’t fair to phrase it that way, but there was some daddy issue there.

Terri, for some reason, was turned on by meeting another man's needs and desires. The problem was, my only need and desire was to protect and please her. There was nothing I wanted that she was not willing to give, but she seemed to need to make a sacrifice, whether dignity or physical comfort. She wanted someone to push her. And all I really wanted was to stay in her comfort zone. And that's the killer. To meet her needs, I needed to realize I couldn't meet them.

I'd been lost in thought so long that Terri grew concerned. "Bill, are you...are we okay?"

The image of Terri, naked, writhing in passion as Chucky sodomized her flashed through my mind. Jesus, he'd almost fucked her into shock. And all she seemed worried about was whether we were okay.

"Terri, baby, I love you. Yeah, we're okay. Or at least, we'll be okay. I think. I don't know where this leads or ends. But it seems like we need to keep going. And in a weird way, I feel like we're being honest with each other for the first time."

She gave me a wan smile. "Maybe. But maybe honesty is more than it's cracked up to be."

"Do you mean that?"

"I don't know."

I knew where she was coming from. We were improvising, taking risks. I forced a smile. "I know you're beat. Go to bed. I'll finish off my drink and join you later."

She nodded and slowly made her way upstairs. I poured myself another generous glass of scotch. I didn't want this to end. Neither did she. But we both recognized the dangers. That, in itself, was reassuring. But would it be enough? I wasn't sure.

One day she texted me at work, said things were slow. She asked if I was free for lunch. I wasn't. My meetings were stacked up through the afternoon. So she asked if I'd mind if she "had lunch" with Chucky. And sure enough, that evening, after the kids were in bed, she confirmed my expectations by graphically recounting that the only thing she'd eaten was him.

That was the first time she'd booty called him, and despite all that had already happened, it was still oddly gut wrenching, mostly because for the first time, it had been initiated clearly by her. She'd always been a willing participant, of course, but that reality had always seemed a little abstract as long as she was just responding to either my prompting or his invitations.

I'd wanted her to take responsibility, but now that she had, it bothered me. It shouldn't have. The alternative was that she was somehow sacrificing herself to meet my needs. It shouldn't have bothered me, but it did.

He initiated the next two meetings, one a straight-booty call that came in just as we'd finished putting the kids to bed, the other a date to meet at a happy hour spot.

The happy hour had resulted in new twist. After making out in the bar, he'd taken her home. He'd stripped her and then produced a set of handcuffs. With her wrists chained behind her back, he'd pushed her to her knees and made her service him until he finished in her mouth.

In bed after, she described it all. The way he'd wound her hair around his fist. How he'd pulled her off balance so that her mouth was impaled on his cock. How he'd used her mouth like a cunt, thrusting hard. It was so vivid, so slutty, so submissive, I came just from her running her fingertip over my shaft.

I got a call out of the blue from Todd Arpel. A former neighbor, we used to grill out together. We were Facebook friends, but I hadn't seen him in a couple of years. He invited me out for a beer.

He didn't waste any time. The beers arrived, and he immediately asked, "Hey, how are things between you and Terri?"

"Great," I replied honestly, albeit without elaboration.

He drained his glass and waved for another.

"Hey, I hate to be the one to do this, but look you're a good guy. I saw her...with another man."

I waved it away. "She has male friends. It's okay."

"Buddy, this guy was all over her. All over. Sucking face in a bar. This bar," he added, nodding toward a booth in the corner. "I'm pretty sure he was checking the oil, too."

It was dark. I hoped he couldn't see me blushing, though my cheeks felt like they were on fire.

"You must have made a mistake. I trust Terri completely." I stood and threw a ten on the table. "Thanks."

I left the bar and stumbled outside. I realized I hadn't taken a breath in a minute. I leaned against the wall and gasped for air, then again, and again, until I felt dizzy. I forced myself to calm down.

When I'd finally recovered my composure, I went down the street into a different bar and ordered a shot. Then another.

The shit had suddenly gotten real. This was no longer just some sort of private fantasy. Somehow, Todd's witnessing it made it even more real, palpable. Jesus, my wife was now regularly fucking another man. And the fact that now other people, virtual strangers, were in on it made that much more concrete.

I don't like to talk about my job. It rates pretty low on job satisfaction, which I guess may explain why I was so vulnerable to disruptions in my personal life that added excitement to the daily grind. And indeed, thinking about Terri and her adventures was an effective way to add a little spice to a day that would otherwise be spent working through a stack of TPS reports.

But I'm good at what I do. Happily senior management sees it that way and pays me accordingly. I've tried to transfer, come to management with other job offers, and they always offer me more to stay in place. It is a case of golden handcuffs to be sure.

But the combination of often anti-social co-workers, tedious daily routine, and the burden of having to troubleshoot every new crisis often wore me down. What made it worthwhile was coming home to my perfect, albeit increasingly strange, life. Lovely home, beautiful kids, perfect wife.

It had been an exceptionally miserable day at work. Just the right combination of time-wasting meetings and unreasonable demands from management to make it one of those days where, despite the pay, I was just a twitch away from quitting.

On the drive home, I thought of Terri. We'd have to play at being normal for the kids. Make dinner. Play games. Put the kids down with baths and books. But I couldn't wait to get her to bed. Hear her repeat her latest

adventure with Chucky. Feel the passion flowing through her. Enjoy that wicked, addictive combination of jealousy and lust.

But when I got home, she was on her way out. Chucky had called and invited her out for drinks and some live music. She'd texted the news, but I'd missed it somehow in the rush of the day.

She was obviously looking forward to it. Her outfit was carefully calculated for the evening: skinny, painted-on jeans; suede, high-heeled boots; a loose-fitting black silk blouse with a lace camisole beneath; a wrist-full of hoop bracelets. Sexy, sexy, sexy, but appropriate for seeing a bar's house band.

"You're okay with me going out, right?"

"Yeah, yeah, of course. Have fun."

She read something in my tone.

"Are you sure?" Then after a pause. "How was work?"

"Miserable," I replied. "I'll tell you later."

She hesitated. I wished that she would stay with me, but I couldn't bring myself to ask for it. I hoped she could read my mind. And I could see her debating it. Wondering whether she should go out.

"Okay," she said giving me a kiss on the cheek. "Don't wait up.... or do, and I'll make it worth your while," she said lewdly.

"Have fun," I repeated a little listlessly, at least to my mind.

And she was gone.

I snarfed down leftovers, put the kids to bed. I couldn't sleep. She knew I didn't really want her to go out, but she'd still gone. Or had she known? She should have. In years past, Terri would have read my needs instantly. But we'd so complicated things that everything was up in the air.

Why did she go? Was she going for me? Because she knew this turned me on, and that after a bad day I'd welcome the thrill of a new experience for her to report? Or did she go for herself? Had she been thinking of it all day, of dressing up for Chucky, of playing with him, or giving herself to him? Or had she been worried about Chucky? Not wanting to disappoint him? Or worst of all, was it just that with another man in her life, she was less attuned to my needs and desires?

She got home late. I feigned sleep and she let me.

The stories from that evening were hot when we got to them. They'd actually made it to the bar. He'd played with her in public, through her tight

jeans, under her loose top. She gave me all the details, as always. But for some reason, this time, it didn't feel the same.

CHAPTER 10:

COMBUSTION

“We need to talk...”

Terri and I were in bed, naked. We’d just finished making love. Terri grinned and ran her hands through my chest hair.

“What do we need to talk about?”

She hadn’t been with Chucky in almost a week, so there was no immediate impetus, but the situation had worn me down—the realization that at any moment a text might arrive and Terri would leave me for him.

“So, where do we go from here?”

She grinned. “Where do you want to go?”

I shook my head. “Baby, I don’t know.”

She paused and regarded me carefully.

“So, what?” She could read my mood better than I could myself. “You’re suddenly freaked out?”

“*Suddenly?*” I replied in surprise.

She drew back, cold, hard. “Fuck you Bill. Don’t act like you’ve been unwilling throughout.”

She’d obviously been expecting a moment like this for a long time, and went zero to sixty when it arrived.

“Shit,” I sighed. “No, I didn’t mean that. But...”

“But what?”

“But...but somehow my vague fantasies turned into hard reality, and I’m not sure how it happened.”

She rolled her eyes. “How’d it happen? You fucking stalked Chucky. Virtually insisted I go on a date with him.”

“Jesus, I know, I know. And God damn it, even though it tears me up, I’d do it again in a heartbeat,” I said.

“So, what’s your beef?”

“I dunno. It just feels... I dunno.... It just feels like this is all out of control.”

She opened her mouth and hesitated. Her reply was gentle. “What’s so important about control? Isn’t part of the excitement that it is out of control? Crazy even? Or at least out of the ordinary?”

“Yeah, but—”

“And anyway, it isn’t really out of control. You know that, right?” She fixed me with a gaze. “You can end it whenever you want. All you have to do is say the word.”

“Really?”

She caressed my cheek. “Yes, really. I’m enjoying myself. I am. But I don’t want this to come between us. We went into this together, and we’ll stop whenever either one of us needs it to stop.”

I looked at her. She was saying all the right things, exuding sincerity. And in a weird way I resented her for it. Resented her reasonableness. Resented her unwillingness to simply let me off the hook.

The truth was, I didn’t want to have to confront my own responsibility in all of this. I would almost have preferred for her to dig in her heels and demand to continue to see him regardless of my desires. That too would let me off the hook, make her the bad guy, expunge my responsibility, allow me to be the victim.

That thought seized me. I imagined her laughing at me, refusing my entreaties to stop seeing him. I pictured her slipping off her panties, flashing me her bare bottom as she taunted me with her determination to continue fucking him, to continue acceding to his every whim, no matter how debauched. My head began to spin. My stomach fluttered. And my cock sprung to attention.

She frowned at me. “Bill, are you okay?”

“No,” I grumbled.

“So, should I stop seeing him?”

“No.”

She looked at me quizzically.

“No, I shouldn’t see him anymore? Or no, I shouldn’t stop.”

“You can continue seeing him.”

“Can?”

I grabbed her around the waist and pulled her on top of me. She tensed until she realized what I was doing, and then she relaxed, straddling me. I thrust upward hard, burying my cock inside her.

“I...want... you...to...fuck...him...” I grunted, punctuating each word with a hard stroke. “I...want...you...to...suck...his...cock... And...I...want...you...to...tell...me...all...about... it!”

I growled as I came inside her.

And then, as she lay on my chest, catching her breath, the fever broke again. And again, I was wracked with doubts. This time I kept them to myself.

That weekend, Terri and I went out to dinner at a nice chophouse downtown. I was looking forward to a big steak and a nice Cab. We started off with cocktails, and talked about upcoming plans. My birthday was coming up and we discussed whether to have a party at home or go out. From outside, we seemed a model of comfortable normalcy.

And then Terri suddenly went pale, even more pale than usual, her eyes wide, her head shaking almost imperceptibly. I was about to ask her what was wrong when a man sat down at our table.

I turned and with a gasp, “Chucky?”

He took my hand and shook it firmly, too firmly—like he was sending a message.

“Have we met?” he asked.

Fuck! Busted. I couldn’t bring myself to admit I’d stalked him.

Terri covered me. “Who the hell else would just plop down uninvited?”

He smiled at her. A megawatt smile. “Hey doll, nice to see you too. I’ve missed you. You haven’t been answering my texts.”

Now it was her turn to be flustered.

I tried to save her. “Look man,” I started, and he turned back to face me. “This is a little awkward, you know.”

He grinned. He knew. And he relished it. I could see him working out what to say next. I wondered what his intentions were. Was he thinking of trying to snatch her away from me? Sweep her from the restaurant and ravish her? My prick stiffened uncomfortably at the idea, but I didn’t dare adjust myself and give it away. Still, he seemed to know. He smiled more broadly.

“I’ll leave you two lovebirds alone in a minute,” he said in a mocking tone. “I just wanted to thank you, man.”

I looked at him suspiciously. Where was this going?

He continued. “For letting me get back with Terri. I always said she was the best lay I ever had.”

“Chucky, don’t,” she pleaded.

But he just brushed away her objection. “The first thing you notice is that great rack, but she also has the prettiest pussy I’ve even seen.”

Terri and I both groaned.

He grinned. “Even after ten years and two kids, she still has the nicest, tightest pussy. But what I really want to thank you for is for giving me her ass. Her anal cherry. That’s something I’ll always remember.”

I stared at him in shock. He just laughed. He stood and winked at Terri. “Come see me soon, okay?”

And then he was gone.

“Oh God, Bill, I’m so sorry. He always was an asshole,” she mumbled hastily.

I held up my hand to silence her.

“Bill? Are you okay?”

But I couldn’t speak. I couldn’t even begin to process what had just happened. It was mortifying. But I was also furious. At him. At Terri for fucking him. And despite that all, I was rock hard.

“Bill, do you want to leave?”

I nodded curtly and threw a couple of twenties on the table. We hurried out of the restaurant, ignoring the maitre d’s efforts to ascertain what was wrong.

Terri walked ahead of me, repeatedly looking back over her shoulder to offer apologies, expressions of concern. All of that just served to annoy me. She was treating me like a child. And while I was having a childish difficulty controlling my emotions, none of my emotions were those of a child.

We got to the parking lot and found our car. Terri started toward the passenger seat, but I stopped her, grabbed her by the shoulder and shoved her face first into the back seat.

“Bill!” she whined. “What are you doing?”

But I was like an enraged bull, and still too wound up to talk. I climbed in after her, shutting the door behind me and draping myself over her. Her dress had bunched up around her waist, and I reached down and tore off her panties.

She yelped in surprise. Her tone became panicked. “No, Bill, don’t. I’m not ready back there. You’ll hurt me.”

I finally found my voice. “Don’t worry. I’m not interested in your precious ass. You can reserve that for your boyfriend.”

“Bill, stop.” She seemed less frantic.

I reached between her legs and found her slit. She was wet with excitement. Not soaked, but noticeably aroused. I pressed two fingers into what Chucky seemed to think was the prettiest pussy in Chicagoland.

“You’re wet,” I said accusingly.

“No... I...”

“You are. I can feel it. What got you turned on? Was it just seeing Chucky? Or was it hearing him talk about what a great fuck you are? Or maybe you just liked the idea of him talking to me about your pussy and your ass? Is that it, Terri, did it turn you on to hear your lover taunt me?”

“Fuck you Bill,” she grunted. “Get off me. This is ridiculous.”

But it didn’t feel ridiculous to me. I wrenched down my pants and without another word jammed my hard cock into her wet twat. She groaned, but I could feel her getting even more aroused.

“You think you need to prove you’re still a man?”

“Shut up!” I said, pounding into her even harder.

“Bill, slow down a little,” she demanded.

I grudgingly complied. She continued, “If you can’t handle the fact that other men find me attractive, and I find other men attractive, then why did you encourage me to take a lover?”

“I can handle it,” I growled.

“Say it then.”

“Say what?”

“Admit that what he said turned you on, not just me,” she demanded. “Say it, or I’m done with all this shit.”

I didn’t know what she meant. What shit? The shit with Chucky? Our marriage?

I stopped thrusting, though I remained inside her.

“Baby, I’m sorry,” I said.

“I don’t care about sorry. I want you to say it. Admit it.”

“Terri...”

“Bill...”

She was right. Of course, she was. It *did* turn me on, and not just because she liked it. *I* liked it. But even thinking that was hard. Saying it out loud seemed almost impossible.

But she was right. Hiding my embarrassment by lashing out at her sluttiness was easier, more comforting.

I sighed. "Okay. You're right."

"And?"

"What do you want me to say?"

"I want you to admit you like me having sex with Chucky. And that you like hearing about it."

"I do."

"Say it."

"Terri..."

"Bill..."

"Fuck, okay. I do like it. I like knowing you're fucking another man."

Adrenaline poured in as I said the words. I began to thrust inside her again.

"And?"

"I like all of it. I like when you go to him. I like hearing all the details. I like when you tell me about how you suck him off, how he comes in your mouth."

I was screwing her harder now, and she was responding, not just getting wetter, but thrusting back against me.

"I like thinking of him taking you roughly. Fucking you in the ass."

We both moaned together at that.

"And fuck it, Terri, it even turned me on to hear him say it. To hear that arrogant prick brag about how good a lay you are."

As I said it, I pictured him sitting at our table and his self-satisfied smirk as he walked away. Something about it was just too much. I came hard, gasping.

As I withdrew my cock from her pussy, Terri chuckled sardonically. "Well, anal sex and now getting raped by my husband in the backseat of a car. My bucket list is getting shorter by the day."

We rearranged ourselves and sat somewhat awkwardly side by side in the back seat.

"I'm sorry. Did I hurt you?"

"No, just startled me."

"Did you enjoy it?"

She rolled her eyes. "Yeah, of course. The best part was the seat belt buckle digging into my face the whole time."

“I’m sorry.”

She laughed. “You owe me.”

“Name it.”

She paused. “Okay. How about this...I want you to drive me over to Chucky’s place. And I want you to stay in the car and wait for me while I go inside and get well and thoroughly fucked.”

“You fucking sl...” I paused and took a deep breath. My heart was racing, my vision shaky. “Okay...okay...” I said calming myself, buying time. Then, “Really?”

She held her poker face for a second, and then grinned.

“No, not really, but I think I have your number, right?” She reached into my lap. Even though I’d just come, I was hard again.

I nodded.

“Can we just go to dinner? I’m starving,” she replied.

CHAPTER 11: EXTRICATION

We were too embarrassed to return to the chophouse, so instead we drove back toward our house and stopped at an Outback. The steak was mediocre and the wine list even moreso, but we had a great time.

Somehow the *Sturm und Drang* of the evening had cleared away the toxic elements of the situation. Things were lighter between us. Still sexually charged, but without the sort of anger and resentment that had built up. And it wasn't just on my end.

"Why haven't you been returning his texts?" I asked at one point.

"I'm not sure I liked the way things were going."

"With him?"

"No. Well, sort of, but really more between us. I'm worried that we're not going to be able to pull back. That we're playing with emotions too powerful and dangerous to control."

"You were the one who argued that being out of control was a good thing," I said.

"Yes, but not so out of control that we hurt each other."

"You mean physically or emotionally?"

"Either? Both? You get so worked up. So crazy."

I looked down.

She continued. "No, I don't mean it that way. Like you're immature or something. The fact that it gets you so worked up is part of what makes it exciting for me, just like the fact that I am so loose with Chucky is exciting for you. But we could so easily hurt each other."

"So, what do we do?"

"I don't know."

I thought for a moment. "If we set ground rules..."

"...then we suck the vitality out of it," she said, finishing my thought.

I nodded. "I like being surprised."

"And I like not feeling like I'm following a script."

"So?"

"Well," she continued. "At the very least, we need a safe word."

"Mangoes," I offered.

“Why *mangoes*?”

“Exactly. Because when else would the word come up?”

She laughed. “Okay. But there’s another thing.”

“Shoot.”

“We need to think about the endgame. I’m not talking ground rules, necessarily, and I’m not even talking limits. Let’s keep that open ended for now. But how does this end? Hell, does it end?”

“It has to,” I replied quickly and immediately the issue came into sharp focus. The idea of Terri having sex with another man was a huge turn on. The idea of sharing her with another indefinitely wasn’t. This was about spicing up our relationship, not embracing polyamory.

“I agree. I don’t want this to become a routine.”

“Right. If we’re going to be bored, we can just bore each other like normal married couples.”

She laughed.

I wanted to be the man she wanted me to be. The man who could push her buttons as effortlessly as she pushed mine. But her buttons were harder to reach—at least for me. She needed to be challenged sexually, but I couldn’t do it, not without losing control. My instinct was to nurture. Fantasies aside, I’d never mistreated a woman, at least not without regrets.

Fuck, but the idea of it was so hot. Of possessing a woman. Of taking her. Using her just to satisfy my urges. It is so easy to feel powerless in real life. There are bills and bosses and laws. But close your eyes, and let your mind free, and your imagination is completely unconstrained. Fantasy is freedom, freedom from rules, regulations, and expectations. And that sort of freedom can often get quite dark.

I had a perfect situation. My fantasies of domination seemed to match my wife’s fantasies of being dominated. And yet instead of being complementary, the result was a feeling of deep frustration because whenever I embraced any element of that darkness, the result wasn’t satisfaction, but guilt.

How many times had I fantasized about coming in a woman’s mouth? Shoving her against a wall and taking her from behind? Holding her down, tearing off her panties and hammering her pussy?

And now I'd done it with my own wife, and she'd enjoyed it. But all I felt from it was guilt. I'd assaulted my wife in the back seat of a car.

And then we'd shared a fun, flirty dinner.

I'd won the fucking lottery.

And yet, I felt like shit about it. I couldn't enjoy playing the aggressor. At the same time, I couldn't deny her the pleasure she seemed to take from it. I'd seen my wife come to life in a whole different way, and I couldn't imagine ever asking her to suppress that side of her again.

We'd agreed to continue our game for now, but hadn't actually discussed next steps. Either he wasn't booty calling her or she wasn't responding positively. I wondered if maybe she wanted to me initiate it, to actually call him myself and set up a "date."

The idea turned me on. I ravaged Terri that night thinking about it. And she noticed.

"What's gotten into you?" she giggled.

"You're just so damned hot," I replied.

She gave me a skeptical look, but didn't push the point.

I wondered if maybe the fantasy was enough. Maybe we didn't need Chucky in our lives. Maybe just the idea of him was enough. Except, it wasn't. To keep the fantasy vivid, I had to feed the flames with new material. I imagined what I'd say to him. To her. I didn't have his cell—only Terri had it—but I tracked down his work number and wrote it on a little Post-It note that I handled so regularly that the edges became worn.

I came home from work at 9:00 pm after concluding a teleconference with contacts in China. The house was almost completely dark. The kids were already asleep and Terri was upstairs as well. I wondered if she wasn't feeling well.

As I walked into the bedroom, I noticed that the air was still damp from the shower. I heard the hair drier blowing in the bathroom. And then on the bed I saw an open shipping package from Agent Provocateur. This was all very promising.

A moment later, Terri strode out of the bathroom and I literally gasped. She was a vision in thigh-high stockings and an indigo lace corselet. A garter and g-string thong completed the outfit. She'd styled her hair into those loose spiral curls I always loved, and while her makeup was generally subdued, her lips were glossy, bright red.

She startled as she saw me. Then smiled.

"I hope you don't mind, but I sort of broke the bank on these."

"For me?"

She bit her fingertip. "No, sweetie, I'm sorry. This is for Chucky."

My face flushed and my heart began to pound.

"You wh..." I caught myself. The word *mangoes* hammered in head. I wanted to call it off. End it. Take her myself. Ravage every inch of her.

She didn't seem to notice my turmoil. Or maybe she did, but deliberately ignored it. Instead, she pulled a short, black, shift dress over her head and stepped into a pair of black stiletto heels.

I forced myself to breathe. "When are you seeing him?"

"Oh honey, I'm already late. If I don't get out of here right away, he's going to punish me," she replied with a convincing tone of wide eyed apprehension. I wondered when she'd become such a talented actress.

"Um, okay."

"And don't wait up, honey," she added. "I think he has a long night planned for me."

He apparently did. She didn't make it home until after 3:00am.

She doled out the story to me in small increments over the next few days. She'd become very adept at painting me searingly erotic portraits of their encounters.

She described in meticulous detail how he'd taken off her dress and pushed her to knees. How she'd blown him, and how he'd held out until she begged him to finish in her mouth.

They'd moved to the bedroom. He'd put her on the bed on all fours, still in her lingerie, and disciplined her—for being late, for not answering his texts. He'd spanked her until her bottom burned. Then he'd slipped his hand inside the corselet and pinched her nipples as she squirmed in pain,

her whines making him hard. He'd taken her from behind, sliding her g-string to the side, hammering her hard, and finishing inside her.

Then he stripped her and put her on her back, ordered her to pull her knees to her chest. He'd fingered her wet snatch, feeding her his digits, making her taste herself mingled with his cum. He'd fingered her ass as she'd squirmed in discomfort. Then he sodomized her, hard, demanding that she tell him how much she liked it.

They showered and returned to bed naked. He produced a fat butt plug, insisted she take it in her ass. Then he rested on his back and demanded she ride him, make him come as he squeezed, pinched, and slapped her breasts.

She told each story in all its particulars, slowly, dragging out each revelation, making me visualize each scene, how she'd felt, how he'd acted, how her body had responded.

God, I was close. She was bobbing up and down on my cock, her hand massaging my balls, demonstrating how she'd taken care of Chucky earlier that same evening. It was intoxicating. Her enthusiasm, knowing she'd done the same for another man just hours before. She looked up at me, her big blue eyes locking on mine, her eyelids heavy. It was too much. With a shudder, I filled her mouth with come, which she dutifully swallowed.

"God, you're amazing," I moaned.

"Chucky agrees with you." She said it with a grin.

Despite having just climaxed, I felt my cock twitch with excitement.

I sat her up beside me and slid my hand between her legs, slowly drawing my finger down the length of her pussy, feeling her puffy labia, gently circling her clit.

"Do you like that?"

"Mmm, yes, of course, that feels so nice," she cooed, pressing against me.

"No, I mean, what you did before. What you did to me."

She laughed. "Are you asking me if I like giving head?"

I nodded.

"I do it enough that I think you know the answer. Why? Do I seem like I might not?"

“No, I mean...but why? Is it just giving pleasure? Do you like the taste?”

She snorted. “Oh God, hardly. Come feels like warm slime and tastes like bleach.”

I felt my face drop.

“I’m exaggerating,” she replied quickly, though I realized she wasn’t. “But the taste isn’t the high point. But...” Her voice dropped an octave and continued with a husky rasp. “...I do like the feel of a hard cock in my mouth. And I love what it does to you.”

And Chucky.

But it was weird. Even though she said she enjoyed it, it made me feel guilty. Even though she accepted the tradeoff, it bothered me. Just not enough to stop. Coming in her mouth, her eyes locked on mine.... God, it was hot. And yet, I wished it wasn’t. I was taking pleasure from her discomfort in a way, wasn’t I? Or was I?

It had always been so simple. Our old sex life, conventional and vanilla, had the benefit of being mutually enjoyable throughout. But now, we were in a different world, where jealousy mixed with excitement, where betrayal became an expression of love, and where discomfort was a source of pleasure. In some ways, I wished we could go back to vanilla. And yet I didn’t.

I never knew it could be like this. And I didn’t want to go back. But I needed to find a way to become congruent. To experience the passion without feeling the guilt. To live the excitement without the constant sense of inchoate dread that plagued me when I thought of Chucky.

My birthday arrived without much fanfare. Terri said she’d take me out to dinner at Mateo’s, which is nice, but just a low-key neighborhood place. After the party I’d thrown her, it was a little disappointing. She seemed to be putting more effort into planning her dates with Chucky than my birthday dinner.

She didn’t even get dressed up. I mean, she looked good. She always does. But her jeans and sweater were a far cry from a lace corselet or a slinky wrap dress. Still, I swallowed my disappointment and tried to be cheerful. We shared a bunch of small plates and a bottle of wine. I kept

expecting her to say something about my birthday, but she didn't, and I admit I was feeling a little sulky as we got back to the house. The kids were at my folks, so at least we'd probably fool around, although even that didn't seem a sure thing given how casually she was behaving.

Once we got home things suddenly changed.

She took both my hands in hers. "Do you trust me?"

"Um, yeah," I replied a little nervously.

She smiled and reached into her purse, pulling out a long, silk scarf.

"What's that for?"

She answered by getting on her tiptoes and wrapping it around my head three times, over my eyes, and tying it tightly behind me.

"Can you see anything?"

"No."

"Good. Do you still trust me?"

"Yes."

I had no idea what she was up to. Did she have a surprise gift for me? A new TV? A new car? Somehow I knew it wasn't anything like that. No, there was something about her tone, about the feel of the silk on across my eyes, that hinted at something sexual instead.

She confirmed my suspicions as she began to undress me. She unbuttoned my shirt and slipped it off. Then my shoes and socks. She took her time with my pants, letting her fingers trace my crotch through the fabric before unbuckling my belt and pulling my slacks and boxers off. She helped me step out of my clothes. I shivered a little, mostly at the awkwardness of being blindfolded and totally naked.

Without a word, she took my hand and carefully led me upstairs. We walked into our bedroom and Terri maneuvered me into a heavy, upholstered armchair. As I sat, I felt that she'd placed a towel on the fabric.

I startled a little as her tongue flicked against my shaft. I groaned as she moved away. I reached out for her, wanting to pull her close, but she just giggled and caught my flailing hand in a firm grip.

"We're going to have to do something about these," she said. She took my hand and pressed it firmly down on the armrest. A moment later, she encircled my wrist with a thick leather strap.

I laughed. "Kinky."

But it didn't feel like a game a moment later when she tightened the strap and I realized I was bound to the chair.

“Do you trust me?” she asked again.

I nodded, although I was feeling very vulnerable, a feeling that only worsened as she strapped my other wrist to the chair. And then my ankles. I was naked, completely at her mercy.

She stood and gave me a kiss on the cheek. Then without another word, I heard her pad quietly out of the room. From downstairs I heard the stereo come on, something with a slow, persistent bass line, though I couldn't identify it further. I don't know how long she left me there. It could have been five minutes or twenty.

I strained my ears to try to make sense of the situation. Was that a door opening? Did I just hear voices? Was she talking on the telephone or was that the TV? Had she just opened the fridge? I yanked at my tethers, and found them to be even more durable than I had realized. I was well and truly restrained.

My mind raced and, as it did, my thoughts turned to Chucky. Had she invited him over? Were they even now fucking downstairs, giggling at my predicament? The idea was erotic and painful all at once.

Then suddenly I felt a presence in the room. I didn't quite hear anything, not consciously at least, but it was a sensation. I was startled when I felt fingertips lightly trail over my bare thigh.

“Terri?”

She, if it was even her, didn't answer. A dark thought entered my mind. Had we crossed into some bizarre humiliation game? I have no idea why, but for a moment I had a vision that the person touching me wasn't Terri, was instead a man, a slender homosexual man, and that Terri and Chucky were in the doorway of the bedroom watching me going gay.

I shivered and instinctively yanked at my bounds. I almost screamed out *mangoes*. But would it have made a difference? Or would only serve to complete their cruel game.

That scenario vanished as quickly as it arose when I felt a strand of silky hair slide across my belly. Suddenly an alternative captured my attention. Had Terri gotten me another woman? Was she even now watching as a young prostitute prepared to blow me? Did it make her jealous? Turn her on? Did she like the idea of me having sex with another woman as much as I liked the idea of her fucking Chucky?

I gasped as the woman took me in her mouth. I felt her nipples brush against my legs. The sensation was so familiar that I knew instantly it was

Terri, although being blindfolded somehow made it feel different. Also was the fact that her technique had changed over recent months. Again I was getting treated to Terri the whore as she blew me sloppily, her hands working my shaft vigorously.

She obviously wanted to get me off fast, and knowing that she would swallow my come when I did was another form of encouragement. Had it really been less than three months since her birthday? Since I'd first finished in her mouth sitting in our driveway? My mind raced through the events since, just small fragments, not dwelling on any one detail, and yet it was enough. Before I knew it, I was coming hard, my orgasm somehow stronger for the restraints which seemed to channel all my passion into my penis.

After I came, she became more gentle, tender, suckling gently on my prick, her head resting against my abdomen. I wanted her to release me so I could stroke her hair and carry her off to bed.

"She's good at that, isn't she?"

I bolted upright and strained at the straps.

"Chucky?"

"Only girls call me Chucky. Guys call me Chuck."

Terri was still in my lap, her bare breasts resting on my thighs, her hands gently massaging my belly. It was intensely intimate, but uncomfortable, embarrassing to know we had an audience.

"Your wife's always been a wonderful little cocksucker," he said.

I choked back my impulse to say, *Thank you*.

He continued his monologue. "You should see the view I have. She's naked, you know. Up on her knees, bent over your lap, flashing me her pretty, bald little pussy."

I couldn't think of how to reply. What to say. I thought of our safe word, but I realized I didn't want this to end. I needed to know what would happen next.

"Maybe I should go in for a closer look. What do you think Bill, should I get closer to your wife's bare twat?"

"If that's what you want," I grunted involuntarily.

He chuckled. "Yeah, that's definitely what I want." His voice was closer.

Terri moaned.

“Terri? Are you okay?” I don’t know why I said it. Her sounds were undeniably those of pleasure.

She didn’t answer.

“Tell him, tell him what I am doing,” Chucky commanded.

“He’s fingering my...my pussy,” she gasped.

“She’s so hot and tight. And wet, Bill. Do you think she’s wet for you, or for me?”

I groaned. “I don’t know.”

He chuckled again. “It doesn’t really matter, does it? Either way, she’s ready for me.”

Terri gasped again.

“Tell him,” Chucky ordered again.

“He’s inside me. His cock is inside me.”

I shuddered, felt my cock twitch. Terri noticed it, too. She took me in her mouth, and as she did, he began fucking her, driving her face into my lap over and over. I could feel the power of his thrusts transmitted through her body. I heard his flesh slap against hers as his cock plunged over and over into her wet pussy.

Then she groaned again, the tone whining rather than sultry.

“Tell him,” he demanded before I could ask.

“His thumb...in my ass...” she grunted between thrusts.

My prick was fully engorged. She swallowed me deep. I gasped. I was close. Then suddenly she pulled away. I whined in frustration. Dark thoughts coursed through my mind as I imagined them pulling away from me, coupling just yards away, forcing me to hear their sounds as I sat in frustration.

But instead, I felt Terri climb into my lap and confidently impale herself on my cock. She was hot and wet, but also loose from Chucky’s rough pounding. In recent weeks, I’d been introduced to sloppy seconds, but this was the first time I’d experienced a freshly fucked pussy, literally entering her seconds after him.

It was an intensely erotic thought, but I didn’t have time to dwell on it. Terri rose and fell on me just twice before she suddenly stiffened.

“Are you okay?” I said.

But before she could answer, I felt it. His cock entering her ass. She wrapped her arms around my neck and squeezed me tight, a hissing gasp escaping her lips. He pressed into her, slowly but firmly, confidently,

brooking no resistance. I felt it intimately, felt his cockhead forcing its way deeper inside her, rubbing against my own cock almost as if there were nothing separating us at all.

He pulled out and drove back into her hard. She grunted. I gasped. Then again. And again. Her nipples were rock hard, pressed into my chest.

And then suddenly she screamed, "Oh my fucking God."

She came hard. And before I knew it, I was climaxing as well. But he wasn't done. Even as my erection faded and I slipped from Terri, our juices drenching my lap, he continued to sodomize her.

I could never have imagined being in this situation. She clenched to me tighter, gasping and wheezing into my ear. He was using her, each thrust palpable as she pressed against me. I could hear him groaning with pleasure, his own sounds surprisingly close. Then with a contented sigh, he finished inside her. I could feel his every shudder conducted through her body.

He withdrew and she relaxed, melting against me, still breathing hard, but her cheek now resting in the crook of my neck. She caught her breath and leaned back, sitting on my thighs.

She removed the scarf from my eyes. Even though she'd dimmed the lights, it still took me a few moments to adapt to the change in brightness. Then my eyes found hers. She gave me a searching look, trying to ascertain if I was okay. I wasn't sure I was, but I gave her a quick nod just the same. She smiled brightly.

Chucky emerged from the bathroom, buck naked, looking very fit and pleased with himself. His dong hung before him, flaccid but still impressive. She'd told me we were the same size, but now I wondered if she'd just been trying to spare my feelings.

She disentangled herself from me, loosening the cuff on my right wrist. I was now free if I wanted to be, but I remained in place just as if I were still fully restrained. He handed Terri a damp washcloth and she wiped herself down with casual ease. It was a small gesture, but telling. My wife had become the kind of woman could unselfconsciously give herself a whore's bath standing naked between two lovers.

She had moved the armchair so that it sat at the foot of the bed, and when he sat down on the mattress, he was positioned directly in front of me, just a few feet away. He patted the bed and my wife curled up beside him like a cat, her head in his lap, coaxing another erection out of him.

“I was wrong,” he said, pausing cryptically.

“Oh?” I replied.

He grinned. “She does have a beautiful pussy, but these tits are just perfect,” he said as he cupped one of her breasts and proceeded to knead it forcefully.

He was immensely pleased with himself, though I couldn’t tell if he got off on the sex itself, or whether it was having sex with another man’s wife, or if what really got him going was fucking my wife particularly.

He was pinching her nipples, stretching them out. She responded like a perfect little submissive slut, sucking his cock more vigorously, massaging his balls, getting him hard. Just feet away, I could see every detail, hear every slurp and lick.

When I looked back up at his face, finally tearing my eyes away from the scene in his lap, he gave me a cocky smile. I couldn’t blame him, although I had a momentary instinct to reach out and slap him silly. He read my mood perfectly because he proceeded to twist in the knife.

“She is so giving. And I’ve been taking everything, haven’t I?” He taunted as his hand slid in her butt crack, reminding me again that he’d taken her anal virginity, that indeed he was still the only man to buttfuck her. “But that’s only fair, considering that you took her away from me.”

There was something about that sentence that struck me as odd, but I didn’t have time to process it before he jammed two fingers deep in her pussy. She gasped at the intrusion.

“Such a juicy cunt. Should I fuck her again?”

I didn’t answer. But I didn’t look away either. And the hungry look on my face seemed to be enough to satisfy his desire for my acquiescence.

He pulled her into his lap and she eagerly impaled herself on his cock. She reached behind her and rested her hands on his thighs, and rode him like that, back arched, face to the ceiling.

“That’s it, baby, fuck me good,” he groaned as he abused her boobs, mauling and slapping them hard. The rougher he was, the more she responded, gasping, moaning, bouncing up and down like a woman possessed.

After a few minutes, he seized her by the scruff of the neck and pulled her body against his. Then reaching down, he spread her ass cheeks and began thrusting upward vigorously, giving me a explicit view of his cock pounding into her pussy, of her anus, red and puffy from his earlier abuse.

I remembered how she'd described the threesome with Jason, how Chucky had played at amateur pornographer, posing them in various positions. I realized now as he put her through her paces that he was doing the same thing again, except with me as the audience. I didn't know whether to be appalled or strangely appreciative.

He spun her around and sat her back down on his cock facing me. He gripped her throat firmly with one hand while the other reached down to spread her labia, giving me another unobstructed angle as he hammered into her clean shaven pussy. Her breasts were jiggling violently, her face red with strain, but her moans were sultry sounds of pleasure.

After a few minutes of that, he grabbed her breasts and squeezed them painfully. She winced and let out a high-pitched whine, but she didn't resist as he used her tits as handles to bounce her up and down on his prick.

He lifted her off him, forced her to her knees and shoved his wet cock into her mouth until his balls slapped her chin. He held her there, his hand wrapped tightly in her hair, as obscene gurgles bubbled out of her throat and spit ran down her cheeks.

Then just as quickly, he stood her up, still yanking on her blond locks, and manhandled her until she was face down on the bed, facing me. He wedged a pillow under her waist, propping up her ass, and entered her pussy from behind. He fucked her brutally, seemingly trying to drive her through the mattress.

Although Chucky was obviously focused on me and my reactions, Terri had been oddly aloof throughout. The only time we'd made eye contact was when she removed my blindfold. But now he seemed determined that she acknowledge me.

"Look at him," he ordered, wrenched her head up and forcing her face in my direction.

Our eyes met. For a moment I thought I could see an entire catalogue of dark emotions fly across her face. Embarrassment, contempt, sadness, anger. Or maybe that was what I thought she should be feeling? Maybe it was what I was feeling?

Then her eyes rolled back into her head, and when she looked back at me, her eyes seemed glazed. Her gaze was blank, lost in the moment. Fuck drunk.

I couldn't tell when she came—even if she did. And if she did, I had no idea if it was once or a dozen times. The sex was rough, physical, and

aggressive. He made her squeal like I never had.

But it came with a price. She was just a piece of meat to him, a convenient hole in which to masturbate. She was a submissive prop to allow him to play out his domination and exhibitionism fantasies. She could never mean so little to me. I could never treat her like he did, but the problem was that she obviously loved it, craved it. I wondered if she'd always been play-acting with me, denying her true desires. And I wondered if she'd ever really been happy with me—could really *be* happy with me—if I could never meet this need of hers.

Still, the scene before me was undeniably erotic. I realized with a shock that I had slipped my hand from its restraint, despite my conviction not to, and that I was stroking myself rapidly in time with Chucky's hard thrusts into my wife. He groaned suddenly and shuddered. The sight of him climaxing in my wife set me off. I came like a geyser, a load of jism arcing and landing in my lap.

He continued to pump his cock into her slowly, making sure she received every last drop of his come. She was gasping, catching her breath, but glowing with satisfaction. She was obviously proud of her ability to take everything he could dish out, to satisfy such a demanding lover.

He was surprisingly tender, caressing her shoulder. He leaned forward and she turned toward him. They kissed passionately, a perfectly appropriate coda to what had just happened, and yet still like a kick in the stomach to me.

The kiss also triggered another realization. *You took her away from me*, he had said. And suddenly it made sense. And immediately I knew it had to end, and end now.

Terri noticed my distress. She opened her mouth, but I cut her off. I didn't need or want Chucky involved in what happened next.

"Damn, that was hot," I said in a cheery voice.

"We're just getting started," Chucky replied.

I forced a laugh as I slipped off my restraints. "Sorry Chuck, Terri and I are going to have some mango smoothies, and you're going to have to leave." I wanted to make sure she knew I was done.

He looked at her for confirmation.

"You need to leave," she said simply.

"Can I at least—"

"No," she replied firmly. "Just go."

It is hard to describe the relief I felt at that moment. She'd disentangled herself from him and stood beside me, naked, freshly fucked, still full of his semen, and yet unambiguously on my side.

He shrugged and got up. "Okay, I'll be in touch."

"Okay," she replied non-committally.

CHAPTER 12:

CONFRONTATION

“I’m sorry I kissed him,” she began after we’d showered separately.

We were in the living room, both of us independently opting to dress in asexual sweats. I’d poured us a couple of scotches.

I laughed. Objectively, kissing was the least of her sins.

“You know what I mean,” she snapped defensively.

“I do. At one point you told me kissing him was too intimate. Have you been kissing him this whole time?”

She stiffened, but didn’t answer.

“Should I take that as a yes?”

“Bill, Jesus, yeah, I kissed him sometimes,” she said. “What do you expect? We were having sex, regularly, you know.” She paused. “You do know. I told you every fucking detail.”

I put my hands up. “Whoa, Terri, this isn’t an inquisition.”

“It feels like it.”

I laughed. “I don’t know if you noticed. But I had a good time tonight.”

“You did?” Her tone was so desperate for approval that I couldn’t help but melt.

“Yes. But we’re done.... With Chucky, we’re done.”

“Okay, but—”

“Terri, what did he mean when he said I took you away from him?”

“I don’t know what you’re—”

“Yes, you do.”

“He and I were together before you.”

“Before?”

“Yes.”

I shook my head. She was a terrible liar.

“So you didn’t see him after we met?”

She hesitated. “I never cheated on you.”

“I didn’t say you did. But that wasn’t what I asked.”

“Bill, what do you want?”

“Just the truth, I guess.”

She just stared at me, so I continued.

“We met at that stupid kick-ball game. I took you out on to dinner the next weekend. Were you still sleeping with Chucky then?”

Again she didn’t answer.

I felt my heart sink. I needed to have this conversation, but I dreaded it. I knew now where we’d end up, knew it would devastate me to hear it, but I needed to know.

“Terri, Baby, I need...”

A tear ran down her cheek. “Bill, why does this matter? This was ten years ago. After the last couple of months, how can that matter?”

“Because it changes everything.”

“Everything? Everything, Bill? It changes that we love each other? That we have two beautiful children? A wonderful home? A great life?”

“Terri, stop fucking deflecting. I’m not going anywhere. I love you. But I need to know what is going on. I’ve been thinking with my dick, ignoring my doubts. Fuck, even using my anxiety to feed my excitement. I’m not blaming you....”

“It feels like you are.”

“That’s your own guilt.”

“Fuck you, Bill.”

I shrugged. “It’s a simple question, Terri. Were you still fucking Chucky after we met?”

“Fine, Bill, fine. Yes, the answer is yes.”

“How long?”

She opened her mouth to answer, but closed it without saying a word. Her silence spoke louder than words.

“Terri, do you remember the Sarah McLachlan concert?”

A look of panic crossed her face. “Bill... don’t.”

“Do you?”

“Yes,” she replied tonelessly.

“And after. After a night of intimacy, of kissing...you remember leaving me on the sidewalk?”

She nodded.

“You went to him after, didn’t you?”

“Bill, that was so long ago.”

“It was long ago, but now it isn’t.”

“What?”

I was getting angry now. Angry as the feeling of that night returned. Angry as I realized that Terri had been disingenuous with me.

“Christ, Terri, just tell me what happened.”

She sighed. Hesitated. I stayed silent. There was nothing more I could say. It was up to her now whether she wanted to come clean. Then finally she looked at me again. It was a hard, distant look, and it sent a shiver through me.

“Okay, Bill, okay. You win. Yes, I’m a dirty whore. A filthy manipulative cunt. When I met you, I knew you were someone I could fall in love with. I knew I had to play you, reel you in. But I wasn’t willing to give up sex for it. I kept seeing Chucky up until I was sure I had you, sure you were mine if I wanted you.

“And yes,” she continued, “I even saw him that night, after the McLachlan concert. Except it wasn’t a night. It was a weekend.”

I groaned in shock, even though everything she was saying was just confirmation of what I already knew.

She chuckled mordantly as if digging her own grave. “I told him we were through. That I’d met another man. And then we fucked.” Her tone was cold, as if she were trying to shock me, but by now I was feeling sorry for her more than angry. I stayed silent, letting her continue.

“We fucked,” she repeated. “And then we fucked again and again. Friday turned into Saturday. He tried to talk me out of seeing you. He called you a wimp. Said you could never satisfy me. I told him it was over.”

“But you didn’t leave.”

She shook her head. “No, I stayed. And we fucked more. It was rougher, darker. He’d always been very physical, but those last few hours...”

“Days,” I interjected.

She nodded.

“That last day was violent. He’d already come so many times. It wasn’t even about sex anymore. He slapped me. He gagged me. He choked me. And then he’d get hard enough to fuck me, and he would. Rough. Hard. I was so sore. But I never gave up. I was going to earn you no matter what.”

I shook my head. There was more here than I could really address. She needed a qualified therapist. I could only imagine what had brought her to that point. Her friend zone/whore zone dilemma was rooted in something deeper. I was impressed at how functional she was given all of her

emotional turmoil, and I took some credit for myself in giving her the kind of stability she needed. But we still needed closure on Chucky.

“You misled me.”

“No—”

“Listen. Terri, listen. I’m not saying you lied. But you misled me about Chucky. You made him seem just like some guy, a random old boyfriend. Someone for whom you had no real feelings.”

“I don’t.”

“You do.” I put my hand up to stop her protest. “And that’s okay.”

She gave me quizzical look.

“I don’t quite get it,” I said. “He’s a cad and sees you just as a piece of meat. But whatever. I get that he represents something for you. Lost freedom. Raw sexuality. Something. He’s always been your safety valve, hasn’t he? When I bored you, or the kids made you crazy, you’d think of him, wouldn’t you?”

“Yes,” she replied sadly.

I put my hand on her forearm. “It’s okay. I don’t have a Chucky. But I have Chuckies.”

She gave me another quizzical look.

“Oh jeez, Terri, I love you with all my being, but there is a not a day that I don’t think of escaping this. For me it is banging that hot intern. Or going to Vegas and having a threesome with a couple of expensive whores. Or, shit, just leaving town, starting anew, by myself, no responsibilities, no obligations. The difference is that my fantasies are just that: fantasies, while yours, well, came to life.”

“I didn’t mean...”

“No, I know you didn’t. That was me, wasn’t it? I admit it. The thought of you with him...fuck, it just set me off. You did your job too well, didn’t you? You convinced me so thoroughly that you weren’t a whore that the idea that you might be was overwhelming to me.”

“Sounds like you’re blaming me again.”

I laughed. “I think we need therapy,” I said. She frowned, and I quickly added, “But in a good way, baby. Not to solve problems, but to reach our potential.”

She laughed uneasily. “I have no idea what you’re talking about.”

“I love you Terri. I always will. I want you to be happy...and fulfilled,” I added suggestively.

“I don’t need anyone but you.”

I smiled. “It’s okay. Maybe you do. But it can’t be Chucky. There is too much history there.”

“Okay,” she replied unconvincingly.

“Terri, don’t just say *okay* if you don’t mean it.”

“I....”

“Terri, be honest. How does it make you feel to think of never seeing Chucky again.”

She started to reply immediately, but I held up my hand to slow her down. She paused and took a deep breath. “We know him. If it has to be anyone, he’s the right choice. He’s safe.”

I shook my head. “No, he’s the most dangerous person imaginable. Look, I get it. There are things he does to you. Things he makes you feel that I can’t provide. I’ve heard it in your tone when you describe what he does to you. I’ve seen it. It’s fucking hot,” I admitted. “But if what he gives you is something only he can provide, then we have a problem.”

“Why overthink this?” she said. “I love you. We both enjoy what he does with me, to me, isn’t that good enough?”

“No. I can’t share you that way. I’m willing to explore your needs, to ensure that you receive those experiences, those feelings I can’t provide. And I’m not just being altruistic, though I am an amazingly generous man.” I grinned. She smiled back at me. “I love seeing you as you’ve been over the past few months. God, you have no idea how much it turns me on to know that my perfect, innocent, little wife is also a dirty slut.”

She gave me a meaningful look.

“And what if I can only do that with Chucky?”

“I can’t live with that. If you need Chucky, then you need him, and you should go to him.”

“I don’t want that.”

“I don’t either.”

EPILOGUE

The next few months weren't easy. We'd unleashed too many emotions to easily go back to normal, even if either of us were really committed to that goal, which we weren't. I don't want to overstate the issue. I mean, there was never a moment where I thought we'd split up, and I don't think Terri ever considered it either.

But that said, anyone who says this sort of thing is easy is lying. There were days when I resented Terri for her desires, and worse, for the way she'd brought Chucky into our lives. She'd misled me about their relationship, and that hurt.

She too resented me sometimes for ending it with Chucky. She felt set up and would get angry at my resentment. But I knew it was more than that. She missed Chucky, missed what he did to her, for her, and she blamed me both for feeding her desires and then, as she saw it, snatching away something she valued. She felt like I'd teased her, manipulated her.

It's not like we fought constantly, or even often. We continued to be intimate with each other and attentive parents to the kids. Ninety-five percent of the time we were perfectly normal, but things were a little raw. We both knew we'd be fine, but we also knew it would take some work.

I was still desperately attracted to the wanton woman I'd seen for the first time over the past several months. I didn't want her to disappear. But I knew that I couldn't say anything about it, couldn't encourage it, not without Terri getting defensive. That was the strangest thing in a way. Even though she'd had the affair, at some level I think I'd wounded her more deeply than she me. Ending it with Chucky was a rebuke and a not-so-subtle statement of distrust.

But I hated the thought that these resentments might force this other Terri back into the closet, encourage her to suppress that side of her so deeply that it became nothing more than a memory, increasingly distant, increasingly disconnected from the reality of our lives. I didn't want to kill that creature, that passionate, vital, terrifying woman who shared a body with my wife.

Even as we slowly worked through our emotions, my professional life took a dramatic turn. My company was bought out, and I was identified as a “key personnel asset.” They offered me a generous retention package, one that both boosted my salary dramatically and gave me the opportunity to broaden my horizons. In addition to running my teams in Chicago, I was now a designate global troubleshooter.

It sounds more glamorous than it is. After my first trip to India—Bangalore during the monsoon season—to troubleshoot a development project there, I vowed to do all my follow-ups there by Skype. I still ended up spending a lot of time on airplanes. Hong Kong. Tallin. Jakarta. Exciting, interesting cities, and challenging work, but not really garden spots. More than once I recalled the old adage *be careful what you wish for, you might just get it*.

But when we signed a deal with a French defense firm for a major project, I insisted to my bosses that I needed to do a site visit to ensure success. Paris in Spring time. I cashed in some frequent flyer miles and got a second business class seat for Terri. We left the kids with her folks and jetted off the Europe.

I’d been to Paris once before. Terri hadn’t. Say what you will about the French, but they know how to eat and drink, and their capital is a beautiful treasure. Even the Nazis couldn’t bring themselves to destroy it despite Hitler’s orders.

I don’t claim to understand the French approach to business. My opposite number was an active duty French Army colonel, Jean-Pierre Thibault, temporarily seconded to a private firm to oversee software development. He met us at the airport. I had expected a software geek in uniform, and instead was welcomed by a tall, slender man in an impeccably tailored suit.

He greeted us and appreciatively ran his eyes up and down Terri. Political correctness is far less advanced in France. Indeed, I think most French women would be more than a little offended if a man did not cast an admiring glance. Terri blushed slightly, though I couldn’t help but notice that Jean-Pierre was exactly her type: tall, dark, and very handsome. He spoke excellent, albeit heavily accented, English.

He drove us to our hotel and insisted on taking us out for dinner that evening. Was he just being a gracious host? Would I have received the same

treatment had I been on my own? Who knows? But it was a nice offer, and we eagerly accepted.

We'd arranged an early check-in, and put on our tourist gear and walked around. Our hotel was close to Notre Dame, right in the center of the city, and we walked along the Seine, holding hands, playing tourist until mid-afternoon when we returned to the hotel and took a nice long nap before dinner.

We dressed. Chic. This was Paris after all. I wore my black suit. Terri had purchased a new dress, vintage style, black and white polka dot with a halter-neck that exposed a generous amount of cleavage.

Jean-Pierre took us to a lovely restaurant on the banks of the Seine with a view of the Eiffel Tower. We were on expense accounts, so Champagne cocktails flowed into a Sancerre with our shellfish appetizers and then a rich Bordeaux with the main course.

In addition to being a computer scientist and program manager, Jean-Pierre was an infantry officer and had seen combat in Afghanistan, Mali, and the Central African Republic. He had great stories of the kind only soldiers possess, but married to an amusingly French disposition that caused him to spare us the worst details.

"Ze fings I haf seen, I cannot bear to repeat in zese circumstances," he intoned with the sort of earnest soberness that signaled existential angst. He could not have been more French had been wearing a beret and smoking a Gitane.

Terri noticed his wedding band. "Why didn't your wife join us this evening?"

"Ah, my wife, she is in Nice. Wif our daughter. We just had our first grandson."

"Surely not," she replied gaily. "I don't believe you are a grandfather."

He laughed. "Zese fings, zay happen sooner zan we realize."

We toasted to his daughter and his new grandson.

Terri pressed on. "Well, if your wife can't be with you, surely your mistress would be available."

He laughed again. "Yes, of course. All Frenchmen must 'ave a mistress. Just as all our police inspectors are clumsy oafs who nonetheless stumble onto the solution to every crime. Tell me Terri, now zat Bill will need to visit France regularly for bizness, would you approve if he took a mistress?"

She looked at me with a naughty grin. “Well, what’s good for the goose is good for the gander, no? What do you think?”

“Ze gander?” Jean-Pierre asked, puzzled.

I laughed. “That’s very generous, sweetie,” I replied, putting my hand on her forearm. Then turning toward him I continued, “She’s all I can handle. More than I can handle, actually.”

He cocked his head to the side and smiled as he looked from me to Terri and back again. Then he raised his glass. “To our spirited wives, zen, more zan ve can ‘andle.” We clinked and drank.

The main course was followed by cheese and dessert, the first accompanied by a delicious aged Port, the latter by an Alsatian sweet wine.

Between jetlag and the alcohol, I was having trouble keeping my eyes open. As we paid the tab, all I could think about was passing out in our nice, soft bed. So when Jean-Pierre offered to take us around to see some of the famous Parisian monuments lit up at night, I answered without looking up.

“I’m going to sleep,” I replied at exactly the same moment as Terri responded, “Sure, I’d love to.”

Jean-Pierre laughed. “Ah, vell, ve can do it another evening.”

There was a moment’s pause. Just an instant in reality, though it dragged out as if in slow motion to me. Finally, I talked myself into it.

“No, go if you want,” I said to Terri, who was watching me with shining eyes.

“Are you sure?” she asked.

I smiled. “Of course. Why not? I surely have nothing to fear if you’re being protected by a dashing infantry officer.”

By Jean-Pierre’s expression, I could tell he was both intrigued and concerned. I rose quickly and shook his hand. “I put her in your hands.”

I leaned down and kissed Terri on the cheek. “Have fun,” I said loudly enough for him to hear.

“Don’t wait up,” she whispered saucily in my ear as I felt her hand snake into my suit pocket.

I stood and briskly walked out of the restaurant. I couldn’t bear to look back at them. The night air was chilly, which was a blessing because it revived me enough to make it back to the hotel. As I cleared the restaurant, I reached into my pocket. I already knew what she’d placed there, but the confirmation nonetheless sent a jolt through me as my fingers discovered her little black panties.

It was a short walk back to the hotel. Less than ten minutes. But I knew that Terri worked fast. Were they already making love? Were the French more understanding of bathroom hookups? Was I the last one at the table to learn that she'd slipped off her panties? All those thoughts thundered through my head, and more.

I stripped off my suit and fell into bed, drunk and tired. No, Terri was going to drag this one out. He'd show her around, probably trying to remain a gentleman, and she would tease him, tempt him, and then finally seduce him. She was going to give him a night to remember, and then she'd come back to me and relive it all. I fell asleep with a huge smile on my face and a raging hardon.

After an amazing and eventful week, we flew home. Hugged the kids, did household chores, embraced normality.

Except not really. Not completely. Sometimes we'd catch each other's eyes, and the memory of our latest adventure would make us share a connected little giggle.

And now, when I see her on the floor, playing with the kids, I realize that what I'm seeing is just a part of her, that there are layers beneath the surface, some of which I probably have yet to discover. And knowing that, somehow, makes me happy.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I have been writing erotic fiction for myself for many years. A few years ago, I began publishing on Literotica.com, under the name misterstan. Most of my stories appear in the “Loving Wives” category, which has become a virtual cesspool of negativity. For every good comment I’ve received, I’ve also received five negative ones. And yet, the positive comments have just been a delight and more than anything are what have kept me writing and publishing. Over the years, I’ve received wonderful support, both in the comments and through email from dozens of fans. They’ve encouraged me and their often constructive criticism has pushed me to write richer characters and most interesting stories. So, to all of you who’ve ever sent me a positive note, thank you, and I hope you will continue to enjoy my writing in this new format.

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

I am longtime reader and author of erotic fiction. I've been publishing short stories on the free website, Literotica.com, under the name misterstan for the past several years. This is my first, but hopefully not my last, venture into longer-form fiction writing.

I write in genres that I find exciting and arousing. Most of my stories are in the slut wife, wife-watching genre, though occasionally I venture into other subject matter.

Reader feedback is what keeps me going. Please feel free to contact me at ben.boswell.author@gmail.com or visit my blog at benboswell.blogspot.com. You can follow me on Twitter [@BenBoswellAut](https://twitter.com/BenBoswellAut).